



TENSION IN MANIPUR
Treatment for injured Kukis faces resistance
NEWS » PAGE 10

BREACHING SAFE LIMITS
Heatwaves, ozone raise cardiac death risk: study
NEWS » PAGE 12



**RISING FUEL PRICES**
Wholesale inflation jumps to 9.7% in May
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THE WAY AHEAD
Resistance, renewal, future of INDIA bloc
It needs a new impetus and a turnaround
EDITORIAL » PAGE 8

**VOZINHA THE HERO**
Debutant Cape Verde keeps Spain at bay
SPORT » PAGE 15



Family refuses to receive body of torture victim

MADURAI
More than three months after Akash Delison, 26, died after alleged custodial torture, his family on Monday refused to receive his body from the Government Rajaji Hospital in Madurai, despite a deadline set by the Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court. » **PAGE 6**

VCK conducts training for party cadre

CHENNAI
The Viduthala Chiruthaigal Katchi on Monday organised a training programme for its cadre on various “contemporary political” issues. » **PAGE 6**

U.S. and Iran reach agreement to end war, re-open Hormuz Strait

Preliminary deal signed digitally on Sunday, says U.S. V-P; in-person signing in Geneva on June 19, say Iran and Pak.; release of frozen assets, reparations ‘essential’ part of deal, will collect navigation services fee in the Strait of Hormuz, says Tehran

Stanly Johny

The U.S. and Iran have reached a preliminary agreement to end the war, lift blockades in the Strait of Hormuz and the Gulf of Oman, and launch substantive negotiations on Tehran’s nuclear programme and the Western sanctions, the two countries announced on Monday.

The agreement was signed digitally on Sunday, U.S. Vice-President J.D. Vance said, while Iran and Pakistan said an in-person signing ceremony would be held in Geneva, Switzerland, on June 19.

U.S. President Donald Trump said during a media interaction in France, where he arrived on Monday for the G7 meeting,



A commuter flashes a victory sign in front of a banner that reads ‘Thank you Iran’ near Beirut, Lebanon, on Monday. REUTERS

that Mr. Vance will lead the country’s delegation for the signing ceremony.

“The deal with the Islamic Republic of Iran is now complete... I hereby fully authorise the toll-free opening of the Strait of Hormuz, and... authorise the immediate removal of the United States Naval

blockade,” Mr. Trump earlier wrote in a social media post. “Ships of the world, start your engines. Let the oil flow!” he added.

Iran’s Supreme National Security Council confirmed that Tehran and Washington had finalised the text of the ‘memorandum of understanding’ on

Vessels cautious despite Trump’s announcement

CHENNAI
While U.S. President Donald Trump on Monday said he had authorised the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz and the removal of the U.S. blockade while announcing the deal with Iran, data suggested that traffic through the Strait remained limited. » **PAGE 10**

Modi welcomes deal, expresses hope for stability

LONDON
Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday welcomed the agreement between Iran and the U.S. to end the conflict in West Asia and expressed hope that the deal would restore peace and stability in the region while ensuring freedom of navigation. » **PAGE 10**

ending the war, while its Foreign Ministry said releasing frozen assets and paying war reparations were “essential” parts of the deal. “The American side has committed to taking measures in both areas,” Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmail Baqaei said at a press briefing

on Monday. Tehran would not collect tolls from ships but fees for navigation services and environmental upkeep would be charged, the Ministry added.

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‘WON’T WITHDRAW TROOPS’
» **PAGE 14**



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with his Slovak counterpart Robert Fico at the Bratislava Castle in Slovakia on Monday. REUTERS

India and Slovakia expand bilateral ties with a slew of MoUs

Sriram Lakshman
LONDON

India and Slovakia on Monday expanded their bilateral relationship with memoranda of understanding (MoUs) across defence, labour mobility, education, digital tech, and other sectors, officially branding their relationship a ‘Comprehensive Partnership’.

“Held an excellent meeting with Prime Minister [Robert] Fico. This is indeed a very special moment for the India-Slovakia friendship,” Prime Minister Narendra Modi said following bilateral talks in the Slovakian capital of Bratislava. The Prime Minister is here for a little over 24 hours – the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister since the founding of Slovakia in 1993.

“Our talks covered cooperation in sectors like automobiles, railways, advanced manufacturing, and green technology. The India-EU Free Trade Agreement will also add momentum to our partnership,” the Prime Minister said. The countries committed to significantly boost two-way trade and investment across areas such as the automotive, electronic, and advanced manufacturing industries.

The labour migration MoU signed seeks to facilitate mobility and the exchange of information between the authorities in

both countries, as per the joint statement. The two sides also agreed to conclude a social security agreement in this regard. An MoU between the Higher Education Ministries of the two countries to facilitate academic and institutional linkages was also signed. Mr. Modi and Mr. Fico agreed to promote the mobility of students and researchers – especially in STEM fields and humanities.

Action against terrorists

The formation of a Joint Working Group on Terrorism was agreed by Mr. Modi and Mr. Fico, with the two leaders “strongly” condemning the April 2025 terror attacks in Pahalgam. They agreed to work towards the adoption of the Comprehensive Convention on International Terrorism within the United Nations framework. The two leaders called for action against terrorists, including those in the UN Security Council 1267 Sanctions Committee list and the sponsors of terrorism.

The two sides reaffirmed their support for multilateralism and called for UN reform, including the UNSC, with an expansion of the permanent and non-permanent seats on the Council.

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3-year-old girl dies after sexual assault

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A three-year-old girl, the daughter of a couple from Bihar, died of injuries after she was subjected to penetrative sexual assault allegedly by a 19-year-old man, also from Bihar, near Gummidipoondi in Tiruvallur district.

Police sources said the girl’s parents work at a steel company in the SIPCOT Industrial Estate.

The accused was employed at the same company, lived in the couple’s neighbourhood, and was known to them. He would often play with the child.

Around 8 p.m. on Sunday, she was playing with

other children on the street, while her parents were at home.

The accused allegedly took her to a nearby shop under the pretext of buying her chocolates and committed the penetrative sexual assault at a secluded spot, the police said.

A passer-by witnessed the incident and alerted residents. A crowd gathered at the scene.

The accused tried to escape, but was apprehended by members of the public.

The SIPCOT police took him into custody and arrested him.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 6**

Three cheers



Chapter one: Children get ready for the first day of school after summer vacations in Mumbai, Maharashtra, on Monday. EMMANUAL YOGINI

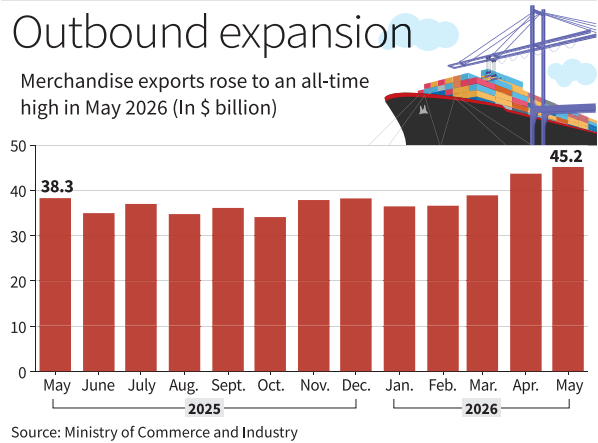
India’s goods exports hit record high of \$45.2 billion in May; trade deficit widens

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

India’s merchandise exports have jumped to a record high of \$45.2 billion in May 2026, 18% higher than \$38.3 billion in May last year, according to official data. Services exports rose 13.2% during the same period, to \$36.8 billion in May 2026.

However, despite this, India’s overall trade deficit widened to \$10.5 billion, from \$6.8 billion in May last year, due to a sharper growth in imports of both goods and services.

Broad-based increase
The data released by the Ministry of Commerce and Industry show that India’s merchandise exports rose in May, due to higher ship-



ments to Singapore, China, the U.K., Tanzania, Bangladesh, Germany, and South Africa, among others. This increase was also relatively broad-based in terms of sectors, with both petroleum and several non-petroleum sectors seeing strong growth in exports.

Within merchandise exports, the electronic goods sector saw exports growing 11.6% to \$5.1 billion in May 2026.

The organic and inorganic chemicals sector similarly saw exports grow by 12.7% to \$2.7 billion during the same period.

Notably, the engineering goods category saw exports jumping 24.5% in May 2026 to \$12.3 billion. The gems and jewellery sector, too, saw a growth in exports of 6.7% to \$2.5 billion in May 2026.

Overall, the data show India’s non-petroleum exports grew 10.5% to \$70.7 billion in the first two months of this financial year.

Imports grow faster
India’s merchandise imports jumped 22.1% to \$73.4 billion in May 2026. As a result, the merchandise trade deficit stood at \$28.2 billion in May this year, 25% higher than in May 2025.

Services imports, too, grew 14.1% in May 2026 to \$19.1 billion.

NCPI claims to be the largest parliamentary force from Bengal after Trinamool ‘merger’

Shiv Sahay Singh
Shenjuti Sengupta
KOLKATA

A day after 20 Lok Sabha MPs of the Trinamool Congress decided to merge with the little-known Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI), the party claimed in a social media post that it has become the largest parliamentary force from West Bengal.

“With 20 Lok Sabha seats, NCPI emerges as the largest parliamentary force from West Bengal shaping the State’s voice at the national level. The numbers speak for themselves...” an NCPI Facebook post said.

According to the post, the NCPI now has 20 MPs in the Lok Sabha, while the BJP has 12, the Trinamool eight, and the Congress



West Bengal CM and BJP leader Suwendu Adhikari with rebel Trinamool MP Mala Roy during an event in Kolkata on Monday. PTI

one. The party also posted photographs of rebel Trinamool MPs with its election symbol – a fountain pen – welcoming them into the party.

The 20 rebel Trinamool MPs had announced their decision to merge with the NCPI after meeting Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla in

Delhi on Sunday and submitting a letter to that effect.

According to the information available on the NCPI’s Facebook page, the party’s head office is located in Hatgachha village under the Sankrail police station area of Howrah district. The Facebook

page was created in the early hours of Monday. The party is run by a couple, Uttiya Kundu and his wife Shewly Kundu.

Later in the day, Ms. Kundu told reporters outside the Calcutta High Court that she was the founder president of this party but had resigned from the post. “The new president of the party can give details. I don’t know who the new president is. In Tripura, we were with the NDA,” Ms. Kundu, who was wearing an advocate’s gown, said. She refused to comment on the merger of 20 Trinamool MPs with the NCPI.

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RELATED REPORTS ON
» **PAGE 11**

INBRIEF



National Surgeons Week event concludes in city

The Association of Surgeons of India (ASI) observed National Surgeons Week from June 8 to 14, and the second annual Surgeons Day on June 14 under the theme “Healthy Surgeon, Healthy Nation”. According to a release, ASI chapters across the country organised blood donation camps, free health camps, tree plantation drives, and awareness programmes. In Chennai, an anti-drug rally with around 500 participants was flagged off by K.S. Narenthiran Nair, Additional Commissioner of Police, Law and Order, South. The concluding event was held at SRIHER, Chennai, where surgeons from across India participated in sports and wellness activities.

City hospital launches centre for paediatric ENT Care

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Rainbow Children’s Hospi- tal here has launched a dedicated centre for the diagnosis, treatment, and long-term management of paediatric ENT exper- tise, advanced technology, and multidisciplinary care to address complex ENT conditions affecting new- borns, infants, children, and adolescents.

Conditions such as hear- ing loss, airway abnormali- ties, recurrent ear infec- tions, and sleep-disordered breathing may go unrecognised in children and could poten- tially impact speech, learn- ing, growth, and overall development. The centre will address this need, the release said.

A one-week-old infant admitted with severe air- way obstruction, feeding difficulties, and depen- dence on oxygen support was recently treated at the centre.

The centre was launched in the presence of renowned playback sin- ger Saindhavi, and Suresh Kumar M., senior consul- tant and coordinator, ENT, KIMSHEALTH, Thiruva- nanthapuram.

Gunasekhar C., facility director and Nithya R., consultant, paediatric ENT, were among those who participated.

Timings			
CHENNAI			
TUESDAY, JUN. 16			
RISE	05:44	SET	18:36
RISE	06:42	SET	20:09
WEDNESDAY, JUN. 17			
RISE	05:44	SET	18:37
RISE	07:50	SET	21:07
THURSDAY, JUN. 18			
RISE	05:44	SET	18:37
RISE	08:54	SET	21:57

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	37	26
Chennai Airport	38	28
Chennai City	38	28

Chennai Airport Today
39°C The weather will be hot and uneasy. Night will also be very uneasy. Spell of light rain and thundershowers may occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
40°C Morning will be comfort- able. Day will be hot and uneasy. Night also will be uneasy. Chances of light rain and thundershowers.



Metro Rail to submit project report of Light House-Madras HC line to State govt. soon

Sources said the Detailed Project Report was completed recently and were planning to submit the document to the State government within a week; an extension of corridor 4, this metro line will be a 5.69-km underground stretch that is expected to benefit lakhs of commuters

TRACK TALES
Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

Chennai Metro Rail has completed the Detailed Project Report (DPR) for the extension lines from Light House to Madras High Court and will submit it to the Tamil Nadu government shortly. Chennai Metro Rail had floated bids in March last year looking for a consul- tant to prepare the DPR and subsequently, in June, Systra MVA Consulting (In- dia) Pvt. Ltd. bagged the

contract for this project. Sources said the DPR was completed recently, and they plan to hand over the document to the State go- vernment within a week for its approval. The Light House to Ma- dras High Court stretch will be a 5.69-km un- derground stretch comprising four stations in between—Ezhilagam, Island Grounds, Secretariat, and Madras High Court. The estimated cost of this project is ₹4,300 crore. Light House, which is under construction as part of the 118.9-km phase II



Crucial expansion: The Light House to Madras High Court stretch will have four stations—Ezhilagam, Island Grounds, Secretariat, and Madras High Court. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

project, will serve as one of the key terminal stations. This station is part of the 26.1-km East-West corri- dor, which starts at Poona- mallee and terminates at Light House after crossing some of the core areas, in- cluding Valasaravakkam, Vadapalani, Kodambak-

kam, T. Nagar, Nandanam, Boat Club, Alwarpet, and Thirumayilai. If the Light House-Ma- dras High Court stretch is approved by the State and Centre and becomes oper- ational, it could be an ex- tension of the corridor 4 and benefit lakhs of people. “Several government employees are employed at both Secretariat and Ez- hilagam. Island Grounds is one of the important exhi- bition spaces in the city vi- sited by many. So, commu- ters will stand to gain hugely from Chennai Me- tro Rail connectivity to these three locations,” a source said. It has been planned un- derground since it is an ex- tension of the already ex- isting line underground stretch. Prasanna Kumar who is employed at Ezhilagam said, such an extension will help people like him to commute to workplace and the Secretariat. “I have had to frequently travel from Ezhilagam to Secreta- riat. Currently, I have to take a bus. But if metro connectivity comes through, it will be far more convenient for many like me,” he added.

Panchu ceased to be EC member in Feb. 2026, says Sai University

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Sai University has said senior advocate Sriram Panchu ceased to be a member of its executive council in February 2026 and it was “factually incor- rect” to claim he had re- signed over charges of al- leged sexual misconduct against its Vice-Chancellor, Ajith Abraham.

In a statement to *The Hindu* the university Vice- Chancellor Ajith Abraham said Mr. Panchu was con- tinuously absent from “five consecutive board meet-

ings with his last atten- dance recorded in Febru- ary 2025” and that he “ceased to be a member of the Executive Council in February 2026—months prior to the events” cited in the article. “Under the statutory regulations of Sai Universi- ty, any board member who remains continuously ab- sent from Executive Coun- cil meetings for more than one year (equivalent to four consecutive meetings) automatically ceases to hold membership.”

Mr. Abraham said re- ferences to “academic mis- conduct” regarding cita- tion practices and publication records were “entirely baseless” and ver- ifiable institutional data and academic records held by Sai University confirm there is no evidence to sup- port these allegations.

‘Factually incorrect’ “The university has thor- oughly reviewed these matters and determined that the claims are factually incorrect and stem from a fundamental misunder- standing of globally accept- ed academic indexing and metrics,” he said.

Man held for sexually harassing woman in lift at commercial complex in Royapettah

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Anna Salai Police have arrested a 41-year-old man on charges of sexually har-assing a woman inside a lift at a commercial com- plex in Royapettah. According to the police, a 38-year-old woman resid- ing with her family in Nun-

gambakkam High Road area lodged a complaint with the police alleging that she was sexually har-assed inside the lift at the private commercial complex. According to the com- plaint, the woman and her friend were travelling in a lift at the commercial com- plex on Sunday evening

when two men standing behind them allegedly sub- jected her to sexual haras- sment. The accused fled the scene when the lift stopped. Based on the complaint, the police registered a case and launched an investigation. After investigation, the police arrested one of the

accused, Lakshmi Naraya- nan, 41, of Velachery. Dur- ing the investigation, the police found that Lakshmi Narayanan was employed as a housekeeping worker at a private company in Velachery. Police said efforts were on to trace and arrest the other accused involved in the case.

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH



RAJAGOPALAN NAGARAJAN
09.08.1944 - 11.06.2026
"All is well" - this simple belief was the foundation of his life.
With a heavy heart and profound sadness, we announce that Sri Rajagopalan Nagarajan has attained the lotus feet of Kāmākshi. A loving husband, father, grandfather, friend, an IIMC alumnus and Rotarian, He will be fondly remembered for his kindness, humility, equanimity, Cheerfulness and unwavering optimism
Deeply mourned by:
Wife: Bhuvana
Sons: Sriram & Aswin and Family
Condolences: +91 98400 48570

DEATH



G. Selvaraju
S/o. Gothandapani,
Passed away on 15-06-2026. Funeral rituals will be held Today @ 11.30am Sudhasana Apt, 10/23, First Cross St, R.K.Nagar, Mandaveli, Chennai-28 Ct: 96000 18666

DEATH



Mrs. K. Rajeshwari
DOB: 08-11-1933 - DOD: 15-06-2026 W/o. Late K.E. Arunachalam D/o. of Late C.S Loganatha Mudaliar She Will be dearly missed and forever remembered Forever in our hearts. Remembered by her Daughter, Son In law, Grandsons and Great Granddaughter and Granddaughter in law Relatives & Family members Ct: 87545 51424

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

11TH ANNIVERSARY



N. LAKSHMI
(EX-SYNDICATE BANK)
Fondly remembered by G.Narayanan and Family ECR Kottivakkam. 98401030855

22ND DEATH ANNIVERSARY



P. PADMA PRIYA M.A., M. Phil.
21.05.1964 - 16.06.2004
Remembered by Husband **P.T. VEERAIYAN**

11th Anniversary

In our loving memory of



Dr. PALLI PERIYANNAYAKI, Ph.D
(Retd. Dean Of Science, Sarah Tucker College, Palayamkottai)
Not a single moment passes by without thinking about you.
We Miss You.
"You are our source of inspiration & your legacy will guide us always"
Fondly remembered by Husband, Son, Daughter-in-law, Grandsons & Family, Tirunelveli

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES

To dedicate a space in this section, Please contact: 044-28576300 from 10.00 a.m. to 6.00 p.m.
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DONATE EYES GIFT SIGHT

BENGALURU CENTRAL CITY CORPORATION			Sl. No.	Name of the Work
 Office of the Executive Engineer, C.V. Ramannagara Division, 8th Cross, 12th 'A' Main Road, HAL 2nd Stage, Indiranagara, Bengaluru - 560038.			24	Ward No. 115, Konena Agrahara - BDA Layout. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 100.00, EMD (in Rs.): 2,00,000.00
No: EE/CVR/KPPP/03/2026-27 Date: 12-06-2026			SC / ST Category - (Call-2)	
SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION (Two Cover System) (Through GOK KPP Portal only)			25	Ward No. 108, Cox Town - Gover Road, Charles Cambell Road & M.M Road. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 45.00, EMD (in Rs.): 45,000.00
The Executive Engineer, C.V. Ramannagara Division, BCCC, Bengaluru invites Tenders from eligible Contractors registered in BBMP / KPWD / CPWD / Railway / MES / National Highway or any State Government Organization for the works detailed below. (Standard Tender Document - KW-2)			26	Ward No. 108, Cox Town - Thimmaiah Garden, Nanjundappa Garden. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 40.00, EMD (in Rs.): 40,000.00
Sl. No.	Name of the Work		27	Ward No. 109, Benniganahalli - Lalbahadur Nagara. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 35.00, EMD (in Rs.): 35,000.00
Improvements, Asphaltng and Construction of CC Roads, Drains and Culverts below Wards			28	Ward No. 111, Kaggadasapura - Malleshpalya. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 30.00, EMD (in Rs.): 30,000.00
General Works (Call-2) - (Others)			29	Ward No. 111, Kaggadasapura - Chaitanya School. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 20.00, EMD (in Rs.): 50,000.00
1	Ward No. 108, Cox Town - PSK Naidu Road. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 50.00, EMD (in Rs.): 1,00,000.00		30	Ward No. 111, Kaggadasapura - Malleshpalya. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 40.00, EMD (in Rs.): 40,000.00
2	Ward No. 108, Cox Town - Gajendranagara and Old Bayapanahalli. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 40.00, EMD (in Rs.): 80,000.00		31	Ward No. 112, New Thippasandra - LIC Colony and Geethanjali Layout. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 50.00, EMD (in Rs.): 50,000.00
3	Ward No. 108, Cox Town - Kalahalli. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 30.00, EMD (in Rs.): 60,000.00		32	Ward No. 112, New Thippasandra - G.M Palya and Byrasandra. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 50.00, EMD (in Rs.): 50,000.00
4	Ward No. 109, Benniganahalli - Pilla Reddy Nagara. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 40.00, EMD (in Rs.): 80,000.00		33	Ward No. 112, New Thippasandra - 515 Colony and Venkateshwara Layout. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 50.00, EMD (in Rs.): 50,000.00
5	Ward No. 109, Benniganahalli - Sadanandanagara. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 50.00, EMD (in Rs.): 1,00,000.00		34	Ward No. 115, Konena Agrahara - Bank Road. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 30.00, EMD (in Rs.): 30,000.00
6	Ward No. 109, Benniganahalli - B. Channasandra. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 35.00, EMD (in Rs.): 70,000.00		35	Ward No. 115, Konena Agrahara - Murugesh Palya, A.K. Colony and Cauvery Nagara. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 50.00, EMD (in Rs.): 50,000.00
7	Ward No. 109, Benniganahalli - Krishnaiahnapalya. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 30.00, EMD (in Rs.): 60,000.00		36	Ward No. 112, New Thippasandra - Surrounding. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 100.00, EMD (in Rs.): 1,00,000.00
8	Ward No. 110, C.V. Ramannagara - Rahat Bagh. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 30.00, EMD (in Rs.): 60,000.00		37	Ward No. 113, Hoysalanagara - Cauvery School. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 100.00, EMD (in Rs.): 1,00,000.00
9	Ward No.110, C.V. Ramannagara-Suddagunte Palya. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 40.00, EMD (in Rs.): 80,000.00		CATEGORY-I (Call-2)	
10	Ward No.110, C.V. Ramannagara-Suddagunte Palya. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 40.00, EMD (in Rs.): 80,000.00		38	Ward No. 108, Cox Town - New Bayapanahalli and Adjacent Roads. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 25.00, EMD (in Rs.): 25,000.00
11	Ward No. 110, C.V. Ramannagara - Vartur Road. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 30.00, EMD (in Rs.): 60,000.00		39	Ward No. 114, Jeevan Bhima Nagara - Anandapura. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 50.00, EMD (in Rs.): 50,000.00
12	Ward No. 110, C.V. Ramannagara - Sanjeevappa. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 40.00, EMD (in Rs.): 80,000.00		40	Ward No. 114, Jeevan Bhima Nagara - HAL 2nd Stage. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 50.00, EMD (in Rs.): 50,000.00
13	Ward No. 111, Kaggadasapura - Malleshpalya. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 30.00, EMD (in Rs.): 60,000.00		CATEGORY-II(A) (Call-2)	
14	Ward No. 111, Kaggadasapura - Surrounding. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 30.00, EMD (in Rs.): 60,000.00		41	Ward No. 108, Cox Town - Kallpalli. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 20.00, EMD (in Rs.): 25,000.00
15	Ward No. 111, Kaggadasapura - Varsova Layout. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 40.00, EMD (in Rs.): 80,000.00		42	Ward No. 109, Benniganahalli - Chikkabanasawadi. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 40.00, EMD (in Rs.): 40,000.00
16	Ward No. 111, Kaggadasapura - Balaji Layout. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 30.00, EMD (in Rs.): 60,000.00		43	Ward No. 109, Benniganahalli - Surrounding Area. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 20.00, EMD (in Rs.): 20,000.00
17	Ward No. 113, Hoysalanagara - Michel Palya. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 50.00, EMD (in Rs.): 1,00,000.00		44	Ward No. 110, C.V. Raman Nagara - Nagavarapalya. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 40.00, EMD (in Rs.): 40,000.00
18	Ward No. 114, Jeevanbhima Nagara - Baba Saheb Colony. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 50.00, EMD (in Rs.): 1,00,000.00		45	Ward No. 110, C.V. Raman Nagara - Kaggadasapura Road. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 30.00, EMD (in Rs.): 30,000.00
19	Ward No. 114, Jeevanbhima Nagara - PWD Quarters. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 50.00, EMD (in Rs.): 1,00,000.00		46	Ward No. 111, Kaggadasapura - Surrounding Area. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 30.00, EMD (in Rs.): 30,000.00
20	Ward No. 114, Jeevanbhima Nagara - Kodihalli. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 50.00, EMD (in Rs.): 1,00,000.00		Calendar of Events: 1) Tender Document can be downloaded from the GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Website: https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in from 17-06-2026. 2) Pre Bid Meeting will be held on 25-06-2026 at 3.30 PM in the Office of the Executive Engineer, C.V. Raman Nagara Division, 8th Cross, 12th 'A' Main Road, HAL 2nd Stage, Indiranagara, Bengaluru - 560038. 3) Last Date for Uploading the Filled Tender Document: 02-07-2026 upto 4.00 PM. 4) Date of Opening of Technical Bid: 03-07-2026 after 4.30 PM. Further details can be had from the above office.	
21	Ward No. 115, Konena Agrahara - Vinayakanagara. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 20.00, EMD (in Rs.): 50,000.00		Sd/- Executive Engineer C.V. Ramannagara Division, BCCC.	
22	Ward No. 115, Konena Agrahara-Muniyellappa Garden. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 50.00, EMD (in Rs.): 1,00,000.00			
23	Ward No. 113, Hoysalanagara - Defence Colony. Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 100.00, EMD (in Rs.): 2,00,000.00			



Ministry Of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises
MSME - TECHNOLOGY DEVELOPMENT CENTRE - (CGDI)
An Autonomous body under Ministry of MSME Govt of India
A-1 Industrial Area, Florissabad 682003, www.cgdiindia.net

**GOVERNMENT CERTIFICATE COURSE ON
CONTRACT DRAFTING, NEGOTIATION
AND DISPUTE MANAGEMENT**

Course Duration **2 Days** (ONLINE) Date: 20 & 21 June 2026
Time: 5:00 PM to 8:30 PM

Course Content: Understanding the definitive contract checklist, Non disclosure agreement, Cloud computing & the law, Contract negotiation, Drafting and review of commercial contracts, Service level agreements (SLAs), Data protection and privacy provisions, Intellectual property licensing agreements, Vendor and procurement contracts, E-contracts and digital signatures Termination and exit management Practical contract negotiation exercises Case studies on contractual disputes... More

Fees : **Rs.4,130/-** (Study material in soft copy shall be provided)

Coordinator: 8603769900, 9953920498, 8168984069
Government of India certificate will be awarded



Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises
MSME TECHNOLOGY CENTRE
An Autonomous body under Ministry of MSME Govt of India
A-1 Industrial Area, Florissabad 682003, www.cgdiindia.net

**GOVERNMENT CERTIFICATE COURSE ON
AI for Pharmaceutical R&D**

Course Duration **4 Days** (ONLINE) Date: 20 & 21 June 2026
Time: 5:00 PM to 8:30 PM

Course Content: Drug discovery process, Clinical trial design, Preclinical testing methods, Dose response studies, New drug approval steps, Adverse effect monitoring, Formulation development, Bioavailability testing, Quality control in R&D, Regulatory documentation, Abuse in drug research, Vaccine formulation, Patent filing in pharma, Nanotech in drug delivery, Ethics in clinical research, Target identification, Lead optimization, Molecular docking, Pharmacokinetics basics, Pharmacodynamics studies, Data analysis in trials, Patient recruitment methods, More Topics

Fees : **Rs.6,540/-** (Study material in soft copy shall be provided)

Coordinator: 8818676612, 9818528498, 9686564246
Government of India certificate will be awarded



TIRUPPUR CITY MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
Notice for Inviting Re-E-Tender
Roc.No.E1/0524/2026/23 Date: 15.06.2026

1. E-Tenders are invited from the eligible bidders for Construction of Animal Birth Control Centre (ABC Centre) at Kovilvazhi in Tiruppur City Municipal Corporation under in General Fund 2026-27.

2. Total Project Cost **Rs.199.50 Lakhs.**

3. The details of the tender shall be obtained from web portal <https://tntenders.gov.in>

4. The tender documents shall be downloaded from 16.06.2026 to 01.07.2026 through the portal <https://tntenders.gov.in>

5. Pre Bid Meeting will be Held on 23.06.2026 at 11.00 A.M at concerned Tiruppur City Municipal Corporation Office.

6. The Last date for downloading the tender document and the last date for uploading/ submission of filled up tender document is upto 3.00 PM on 01.07.2026.

7. The received tenders will be opened at 3.30 PM on 01.07.2026 at the Office of Tiruppur City Municipal Corporation, Municipal Office Road, Tiruppur – 641 604.

8. The value of each works and the details of Earnest Money Deposit and the Eligibility of bidders are given in the concern work tender document.

Commissioner,
Tiruppur City Municipal Corporation

DIPR/2068/TENDER/2026



TIRUPPUR CITY MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
Notice for Inviting E-Retender
Roc.No.E1/5846/2025 Date: 15.06.2026

1. E-Tenders are invited from the eligible bidders for Supply, delivery, erection, Commissioning and testing of Shedder machine with conveyor weigh bridge, magnetic separator and hydraulic bailing press with chain conveyor and auto-tied (5 TPH) with control panel under in 15 CFC (Tied & Un Tied Grant) 2025-26.

2. Total Project Cost **Rs.384.18 Lakhs**

3. The details of the tender shall be obtained from web portal <https://tntenders.gov.in>

4. The tender documents shall be downloaded from 16.06.2026 to 01.07.2026 through the portal <https://tntenders.gov.in>

5. Pre Bid Meeting will be Held on 23.06.2026 at 11.00 A.M at concerned Tiruppur City Municipal Corporation Office.

6. The Last date for downloading the tender document and the last date for uploading/ submission of filled up tender document is upto 3.00 PM on 01.07.2026.

7. The received tenders will be opened at 3.30 PM on 01.07.2026 at the Office of Tiruppur City Municipal Corporation, Municipal Office Road, Tiruppur – 641 604.

8. The value of each works and the details of Earnest Money Deposit and the Eligibility of bidders are given in the concern work tender document.

Commissioner,
Tiruppur City Municipal Corporation

DIPR/2067/TENDER/2026



INDIAN RAILWAYS
PATIALA LOCOMOTIVE WORKS
PATIALA - 147003
Tel.: 2396000, 2396001, Fax No. : 91-0175-2306413

Notice Inviting Electronic Tenders

On behalf of President of India Principal Chief Materials Manager/PLW/Patiala invites tenders in electronic form for following items:
e-Tender Notice No. 11 ET/2026-27

S. N.	Tender No.	Description	Qty.	Tender Closing Date
1	21261108	Cab Heater/Ventilation Assy	227 Sets	13.07.2026*
2	12261444	Thinner 3A-110/Thinner S-110	1780 kg	10.07.2026*
3	02261039	Bare magnet frame	1776 Sets	06.07.2026*
4	12251828D	Gas Mask Respirator	684 Nos.	06.07.2026
5	21261152	Blind Installation	162 Sets	08.07.2026*
6	21261078A	Sand Box Assy	154 Sets	01.07.2026*
7	21261133	Wheel Set Guide	1514 Nos.	03.07.2026*

Tender closing Time 15:00 Hrs.

Item marked with * is reserved for procurement from CLW approved sources.

The prospective Tenderers are advised to visit the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> or <http://www.plw.indianrailways.gov.in>, for detailed description of items & other terms and conditions of tender document. Please note that Tenderers can submit their quotations only through <http://www.ireps.gov.in>.

2040/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE



MANGALORE ELECTRICITY SUPPLY COMPANY LIMITED
(A Government of Karnataka undertaking)
Corporate Office, "MESCOM BHAVANA", Bejai, Mangalore - 575 004
Ph: 0824-2885795 CIN: U40109 KA 2002 SGC 030425

No. E-299008/308899/62138 Date: 12.06.2026

SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION (THROUGH KPP PORTAL ONLY)

MESCOM invites Short term tender for Manufacture & Supply of following materials.

Sl. No	Tender No	Particulars of Materials proposed to be Procured	Quantity
1	MESCOM/2025-26/INDO157/CALL-2	LT Single Phase Reference Standard Meters	7 Nos
		LT Three Phase Reference Standard Meters	5 Nos
		HT Reference Standard Meters	3 Nos
2	MESCOM/2026-27/INDO158/CALL-2	7/10SWG Guy Wire	150 MT
3	MESCOM/2026-27/INDO159/CALL-2	Silver Memento as per specification	66 No's.

The interested bidders may log on to www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in on or after 16.06.2026.

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer (Ele) (Procurement)

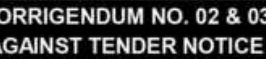
DIPR/DKMSKCA/377/26-27dt: 15.06.2026

For Power Related Complaints contact:
MESCOM Helpline: 1912
9483041912 mescom_official mescom_official



THE HINDU

Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-



**CORRIGENDUM NO. 02 & 03
AGAINST TENDER NOTICE
NO.: CON/2026/MAY/04;
DATED: 20-05-2026**

Corrigendum- 02 and 03 for Tender No. CE-CON-FT-PMS-2026-03RT1 has been published. For details please visit www.ireps.gov.in.

Chief Engineer/Con/
Lumding Project, Maligaon
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
(Construction Organisation)
"SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE"



EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-AUCTION NOTICE

On behalf of president of India, DRM (Commercial), E-C Railway, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya invites e-auction for leasing of parcel space in SLR Coach of under mentioned Coaching trains originating over Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya division. Details are as under- (1) (AA/1) Name of work with train no. and completion period: Allotment of Parcel Space of FSLR (4 T) of Train no. 13024 (Ex Gaya to HWH) GAYA-Howrah Exp. E-Auction Catalogue No.: SLR-LEASE 26-6, E-Auction Lot No.: 13024-SLR-F1-GAYA-HWH-25-1, Date & Time for E-Auction: E-auction will start at 10:00 hrs and close at 10:30 hrs on 26.06.2026. (AA/2) Name of work with train no. and completion period: Allotment of Parcel Space of FSLR (4 T) of Train no. 13697 (Ex Gaya to DLI) GAYA-DLI Amrit Bharat Exp. E-Auction Catalogue No.: SLR-LEASE 26-6, E-Auction Lot No.: 13697-SLR-F1-GAYA-DLI-25-1, Date & Time for E-Auction: E-auction will start at 10:00 hrs and close at 10:40 hrs on 26.06.2026. (AA/3) Name of work with train no. and completion period: Allotment of Parcel Space of FSLR (4 T) of Train no. 12397 (Ex Gaya to NDLs) GAYA-NEW DELHI Mahabodhi Exp. E-Auction Catalogue No.: SLR-LEASE 26-6, E-Auction Lot No.: 12397-SLR-F1-GAYA-NDLS-25-1 Date & Time for E-Auction: E-auction will start at 10:00 hrs and close at 10:50 hrs on 26.06.2026. (AA/4) Name of work with train no. and completion period: Allotment of Parcel Space of FSLR (3.9 T) of Train no. 22409 (Ex Gaya to Anand Vihar Terminus) GAYA-ANVT Canebrath Exp. E-Auction Catalogue No.: SLR-LEASE 26-6, E-Auction Lot No.: 22409-SLR-F1-GAYA-ANVT-25-1 Date & Time for E-Auction: E-auction will start at 10:00 hrs and close at 11:00 hrs on 26.06.2026. (AA/5) Name of work with train no. and completion period: Allotment of Parcel Space of FSLR (4 T) of Train no. 12389 (Ex Gaya to MAS) GAYA-Chennai Egmore Exp. E-Auction Catalogue No.: SLR-LEASE 26-6, E-Auction Lot No.: 12389-SLR-F1-GAYA-MAS-25-1, Date & Time for E-Auction: E-auction will start at 10:00 hrs and close at 11:10 hrs on 26.06.2026. (2) Website particular where complete details of E-Auction available: www.ireps.gov.in (E-auction Leasing)

Divisional Railway Manager (C)
East Central Railway, DDU
PR/0397/DDU/COMML/EAN/26-27/64



The Andhra Pradesh Mineral Development Corporation Limited
Door No. 294/1D, 100 feet Road (Tadigadapa to Enikepadu Road), Kanuru, Vijayawada-521137, Andhra Pradesh, India, Tel: +91-866-2429989 Fax: +91-866-2429977, Email: contracts-ho@apmdc.in

SHORT TERM TENDER

Ref: APMDC/HO/P&C/Science Lab Equipment - APMDC - DAV Model School at Sulivari/2025-26/III, Date: 16.06.2026.

APMDC invites E-tender from reputed Agencies for "Supply of Laboratory Setup Accessories to APMDC - DAV Model School at Sulivari Coal Project, Madhya Pradesh". For more information on the eligibility criteria, tender fees, timelines and other details, please visit APMDC website (www.apmdc.ap.gov.in). The Tender document is available for downloading from APMDC website from 16.06.2026 and the last date for submission of bid is 23.06.2026.

Place : Vijayawada Sd/- Managing Director
Date : 16-06-2026 The A.P. Mineral Development Corporation Limited
DIPR No.5172PP/CL, Dt:15.06.2026



Metro Railway, Kolkata

e-Tender is invited by Principal Chief Engineer, Metro Railway for the following work: Name of work: Providing facilitation for the work of mutation, reconciliation of land plan and data and Digitisation of data of acquired land of Metro Railway/Kolkata in consultation with West Bengal Govt. in North Section of Blue Line from Dakshineswar Station (KDSW) (in.) to Central Station (KCEV) (in.) of Metro Railway/Kolkata. Approx Cost of Work: ₹ 67.03,101.00; Earnest Money: ₹ 1,34,100.00; Completion Period: 12 (Twelve) Months; Date and Time of Closing: 08.07.2026 at 12:00 Hrs.; The Tender Document and other details can be obtained from the website www.ireps.gov.in Amendments/Corrigendum, if any, would be uploaded only on the website

Abridged e-Tender Notice No.: Civil-2575-2026-(Open)
Follow us at: [@metrorailwaykol](https://twitter.com/metrorailwaykol) [metrorailkolkata](https://www.facebook.com/metrorailkolkata)



THE HINDU
businessline

Your feedback will keep us
Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder

Call our toll-free number
1800 102 1878

Or write to us at
customercare@thehindu.co.in

Scan the QR code to register your feedback

FRONTLINE SPORTSTAR thehindu Your world THE HINDU



SOUTHERN RAILWAY
Madurai Division

Tender Notice No: U-TRD-OT-26-27-IV dated 12.06.2026

Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, Southern Railway, Madurai - 625016 invites E-Tenders from reputed contractors for the under mentioned works.

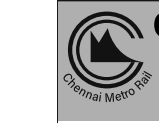
S.No	Tender No & Name of the Work:	Tender No.	App. Tender Value (Rs.)	Bid Security (Rs.)	Tender Closing Date @ 15.00 hrs	Completion Period
1*	U-TRD-OT-26-27-IV-1: MDU Division - Provision of Power Quality Restorers for AC Traction Systems at the Traction Substations in Palani, Gomangalam, Manamadurai, Ramanathapuram and Theni.	U-TRD-OT-26-27-IV-1	19,27,29,000/-	38,54,600	15.07.2026	18 Months
2	U-TRD-OT-26-27-IV-2: MDU Division - Preparation of design and drawings for Overhead Equipments (OHE) for TPJ-MDU section in MDU Division	U-TRD-OT-26-27-IV-2	25,06,540/-	50,100	06.07.2026	6 Months

Cost of Tender Form: NIL

*Eligibility criteria is applicable for these tenders.

For details interested persons may kindly be log on to website at <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. For eligibility criteria, other details, terms and conditions, the tenderers are advised to refer to the documents uploaded. All Addendum/ Corrigendum, Time extension, Clarifications, etc. will be uploaded in the website only and will not be published separately in Newspapers. Bidders should regularly visit website to keep themselves updated.

Divisional Railway Manager (Traction Distribution)
Southern Railway, Madurai - 625016



CHENNAI METRO RAIL LIMITED
(A Joint Venture of Govt. of India & Govt. of Tamil Nadu)
(ISO 9001:2015 AND ISO 14001:2015 CERTIFIED)
METRO S, ANNA SALAI, NANDANAM, CHENNAI - 600 035.

Form-B
(See rule 4)

Public Notice under sub-section (2) of section 3 of the Tamil Nadu Acquisition of Land for Industrial Purposes Act, 1997 (Tamil Nadu Act 10 of 1999)

Under sub-section (2) of section 3 of the Tamil Nadu Acquisition of Land for Industrial Purposes Act, 1997 (Tamil Nadu Act 10 of 1999), notice is hereby given that the land / lands specified in the Schedule and situated in the Village of **Poonamallee** in the Taluk of **Poonamallee** in the District of **Tiruvallur** is required for industrial purposes, to wit, for **Corridor 4, 29 - Poonamallee Bus Stand Metro Station**. All persons interested in the land/lands is/are, accordingly required to lodge before the **Special District Revenue Officer (LAO), Metro S, Anna Salai, Nandanam, Chennai - 600 035** within **Thirty Days** from the date of publication of this notice, a statement in writing of their objections, if any, to the acquisition of the said lands.

Public hearing will be conducted on 17.07.2026 at 11.00 a.m. by the **Special District Revenue Officer (LAO), Metro S, Anna Salai, Nandanam, Chennai - 600 035** when objectors will be at liberty to appear in person or by a person or persons authorized by him or them in this behalf by a pleader and to adduce any oral or documentary evidence in support of their objections.

S. No.	Block No.	T.S. No.	Classification / Description	Extent required / acquired (in Sq.mt.)	Owner / Person interested As per Revenue Record (Extract of PLR)
(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
1.	-	1357/11A	Ryotwari Dry - ACC Building (Oil Mill)	1548	1. Tmt. Manoranjitham 2. Tmt. Indhumathi 3. Tmt. Vasantha 4. Tmt. Gnanasoundari 5. Thiru. Baskaran

Special District Revenue Officer (LAO), Chennai Metro Rail Limited, Nandanam, Chennai - 600 035.

DIPR/101/Land/2026



भारत सरकार / GOVERNMENT OF INDIA, अंतरिक्ष विभाग / DEPARTMENT OF SPACE
विक्रम साराभाई अंतरिक्ष केंद्र / VIKRAM SARABHAI SPACE CENTRE
निर्माण एवं अनुसंधान ग्रुप / CONSTRUCTION AND MAINTENANCE GROUP
तिरुवनन्तपुरम / THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - 22 (फोन नं. / Ph. No. 0471 - 2564568 / 5669 / 4545)

दिनांक/Dated : 15-06-2026

ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करते हुए संक्षिप्त सूचना / BRIEF NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

भारत के राष्ट्रपति को ओर से निम्नलिखित कार्य के लिए ई-टेंडिंग द्वारा ऑनलाइन मद-दर निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। On behalf of the President of India, online item-rate tenders are invited through E-tendering for the following work.

1. टर्क्स, वीएसएससी, तुंबा में जेस नोडक दहन अनुसंधान गुप (एसपीसीजी) के लिए दहन का निर्माण (सिविल तथा विद्युत कार्य) / Construction of building for Solid Propellant Combustion Research Group (SPCG) at TERLS, VSSC, Thumba (Civil & Electrical works) / NIT No. VSSC/CMG/C01/09/2026-27 Dt. 12.06.2026 (पी.ए.सी./P.A.C.: ₹ 1086.85 लाख/Lakhs)

डाउनलोड करने की अवधि/Period for downloading: दिनांक 13.06.2026 को 10.00 बजे/hrs. से/To दिनांक 03.07.2026, 23.00 बजे/hrs. इच्छुक निविदाकार व्यौरों के लिए www.tenderwizard.com/isro या www.isro.gov.in देखें। Interested tenderers may visit www.tenderwizard.com/isro or www.isro.gov.in for details.

Sd/- प्रधान, सौरभजी, वीएसएससी
Head, CMG, VSSC



CENTRE FOR CULTURAL RESOURCES AND TRAINING (CCRT)
Ministry of Culture Government of India
Plot No. 15 A, Sector - 7, Dwarka, New Delhi - 110075

AWARD OF SENIOR / JUNIOR FELLOWSHIPS TO OUTSTANDING PERSONS IN THE FIELD OF CULTURE FOR THE BATCH YEAR 2026-27

Offline applications are invited by CCRT, Ministry of Culture, Govt. of India for the award of Junior and Senior Fellowship for undertaking research oriented projects in the field of Performing, Literary, Visual/Plastic Arts and New Areas related to Culture.

Applications are invited for the year 2026-27 with effect from dated 15th June, 2026. There are 200 Junior & 200 Senior Fellowships for this year. Details of the schemes, instructions for applicants, eligibility conditions/criteria and Application Module are available on the following websites of the Ministry of Culture, Government of India and CCRT.

www.indiaculture.nic.in & www.ccrtindia.gov.in

ONLY OFFLINE APPLICATIONS WILL BE ACCEPTED

The last date for submitting the completely filled application form by post or by hand etc. to the above mentioned address of CCRT, New Delhi is 31st July, 2026.

CBC 09127/11/0005/2627



EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

CORRIGENDUM

Notice No.: W.584/E-Tendering/89-108-DHN-26-27, Dhanbad, dt. 12/06/2026

It is further to notify that the date & time of closing and opening of the following e-tenders should be read as under:

SI No. 1, E-tender No.: 89-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 2, E-tender No.: 90-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 3, E-tender No.: 91-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 4, E-tender No.: 92-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 5, E-tender No.: 93-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 6, E-tender No.: 94-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 7, E-tender No.: 95-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 8, E-tender No.: 96-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 9, E-tender No.: 97-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 10, E-tender No.: 98-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 11, E-tender No.: 99-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 12, E-tender No.: 100-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 13, E-tender No.: 101-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 14, E-tender No.: 102-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 15, E-tender No.: 103-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 16, E-tender No.: 104-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 17, E-tender No.: 105-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 18, E-tender No.: 106-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 19, E-tender No.: 107-DHN-2026-27, SI No. 20, E-tender No.: 108-DHN-2026-27, Existing Date & Time of closing and opening of e-tender already published: Date of closing of e-tender at 12:00 hours on 29.06.2026, Date of opening of e-tender from 12:30 hrs. on 29.06.2026, Date & Time of closing and opening of e-tender should be read as : Date of closing of e-tender at 12:00 hours on 03.07.2026, Date of opening of e-tender from 12:30 hrs. on 03.07.2026.

All other details, term and condition exists in the e-tender notice No. 89-DHN-2026-27, to 108-DHN-2026-27 dttd. 05.06.2026 will remain unchanged and unaltered.

Div. Railway Manager (Engg.)
East Central Railway, Dhanbad
PR/0399/DHN/ENGG/Corrigendum/26-27/52



I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith.
—2 Timothy 4:7

Well done, good and faithful servant... Enter into the joy of your Lord.
—Matthew 25:23

It is with deep sadness that we announce that **Shri R. Augustine Manohar**, IRS (Retd.) aged 78 years, entered into eternal rest with the Lord on **14 June 2026**.

May his soul rest in the peace of Christ.

The mortal remains will reach his residence at **Plot No. 19, Shanthi Niketan Extension, Madambakkam, Chennai 600126** on **17 June 2026**

The funeral service will be held at **2:00 PM at St. John's Church, Madambakkam, followed by burial at 4:00 PM at St. Mary's Cemetery, Mandaveli**

→ Deeply Mourned by ←
Wife: Janet Augustine
Sons: Samuel Augustine, Frank Noble
Daughter in law: Beulah Samuel, R. Umamaheswari
Grand Children: Joanna Princess Augustine, Christina Evangeline Augustine, Kevin Noble, Kayal Janet Noble

Frank Noble: 9479314337
G Raja: 9841214344



**GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF EDUCATION
DEPARTMENT OF HIGHER EDUCATION**

Appointment of Vice-Chancellor of Central University of Jammu

Applications are invited for the post of **Vice-Chancellor of Central University of Jammu**

The Vice-Chancellor, being the academic as well as administrative head, is expected to be:

- A person possessing the highest level of competence, integrity, morals and institutional commitment.
- A distinguished academican, with a minimum of 10 years' experience as Professor in a University or 10 years' experience in reputed research and/or academic administrative organization with proof of having demonstrated academic leadership.
- Preferably not more than 65 years of age as on the closing date of receipt of applications of this advertisement.

Salary and Service Conditions

- The post carries a pay of Rs. 2, 10,000/- (Fixed) per month with Special Allowance of Rs.11,250/- and other usual allowances.
- The terms and conditions of the services will be those as set forth in the Act, Statutes and Ordinances of the University.

Procedure for appointment

- Appointment will be made from a panel of names recommended by a committee constituted under the provisions of Act of the University.
- The advertisement is available on the websites <https://dohe-education.gov.in> and <https://www.cujammu.ac.in>
- Candidates are required to "APPLY ONLINE ONLY" on the Ministry of Education SAMARTH portal as per the link given below:

<https://vcrec.samarth.ac.in/index.php/>

- The above link will be active from **16.06.2026**, 10:00 Hours to **15.07.2026**, 17:00 Hours.

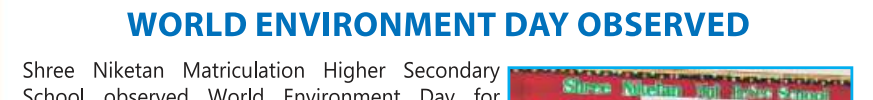
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THE HINDU PRESENTS **SCHOOL BUZZ**
A Newspaper exclusively curated for School Students

GLOBAL LEARNING EXPERIENCE

Greenfield Chennai International School participated in the NGTM Conclave at Sunway University, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia, providing students with an enriching international learning experience. A team of 40 students took part in competitions including Poster Making, Drawing, Short Film Making, Folk Song, Eco Pitch Invention and Slogan Writing, showcasing creativity, innovation and teamwork. Students toured the university campus, took the Plastic-Free Nation Oath and joined the Green India environmental initiative. They also explored cultural landmarks in Putrajaya and Kuala Lumpur. The programme offered valuable exposure to global perspectives, sustainability, cultural diversity and experiential learning.



WORLD ENVIRONMENT DAY OBSERVED

Shree Niketan Matriculation Higher Secondary School observed World Environment Day for students of Grades VI to IX through a special assembly themed "Nature's Warning". The programme focused on environmental protection and climate change, highlighting the impact of human activities on nature. An informative talk explained the causes and effects of climate change and encouraged eco-friendly practices. Students took an Environment Pledge, committing to conserve resources, reduce waste and protect nature. Teachers also conducted classroom discussions and interactive sessions on climate change, with students actively participating and sharing their views on environmental conservation and sustainability.



WORLD ENVIRONMENT DAY OBSERVED

Zion International Public School observed World Environment Day with an awareness rally conducted on the school campus. Students enthusiastically participated, carrying colourful placards and banners promoting messages such as saving trees, reducing waste, recycling and protecting the planet. The programme aimed to create environmental awareness and encourage sustainable practices among students. Participants were also addressed on key issues including water conservation, reducing plastic consumption and the importance of afforestation. The event reflected the school's commitment to nurturing environmentally responsible citizens. It concluded with students and staff renewing their pledge to support environmental conservation and sustainable living.

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Politics over people

Pragmatism should guide India's demographic governance

In constituting a panel to study demographic changes in India, the Centre was guided by a paranoid mindset that saw devious conspiracies everywhere. The move gave shape and substance to a thought expressed by Home Minister Amit Shah: “unnatural demographic change” is a “very significant challenge to the present and future of any nation”. In his Independence Day address in 2025, Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the proposal, characterising illegal infiltration as a “premeditated conspiracy” to alter India’s demography. The committee, chaired by retired Supreme Court judge Justice P.P. Nao-lekar, is to assess demographic changes, examine patterns of abnormal population shifts among religious and social communities, and recommend a time-bound solution. Mr. Shah linked demographic changes not only to sovereignty but also to national security, law and order, “profound changes in social structure and the preservation of tribal society”. According to the government, demographic shifts have affected public service delivery, local governance, resource distribution and social cohesion, and Justice Naolekar has said that the panel will also formulate a system for the custody and deportation of infiltrators.

It is indeed true that the management of population dynamics is a key instrument of governance. On June 14, Switzerland held a referendum and rejected a proposal to cap the country’s population at 10 million. Across the world, immigration has become contentious, with unregulated cross-border movement seen as a challenge to sovereignty. Population management, however, is not entirely about illegal infiltration, and securitising demographic trends at the cost of all adjacent factors could do more harm than good. As the recent experience with the SIR of electoral rolls shows, facts about people would be seen as valid only to the extent that these are established through documentation. If this exercise creates a large stateless population with no country willing to accept them, it could result in a demographic deadlock rather than a solution. The fear of communal profiling of Muslims is real, and the Centre should also seriously consider whether the human costs are worth it. India faces major demographic challenges. Rising life expectancy and falling birth rates are changing the composition of India’s population. There are concerns of India losing its demographic dividend, as the quality of education and health, and the evolving dynamics of work, remain very challenging. Migration continues to shape India’s trajectory. Partition created three sovereign countries out of a geographical and cultural continuum, and its legacy included voluntary and involuntary movement of people. Sensitivity and a long-term view should guide India’s demographic governance.

Peace with peace

Preventive detentions are misused by the state in the name of order

In *Chander Pal Singh*, a matter involving preventive proceedings, the Allahabad High Court has simultaneously addressed a part of the criminal justice system that often receives less attention than ordinary criminal proceedings and the more overbearing reality of mechanisms designed to avert disturbances having gradually become instruments to deprive people of liberty. The state has the power to intervene before a crime occurs if it is reasonably apprehensive that a person is a threat to public order. However, it has acquired a habit of exercising that power routinely, resulting in detentions without any substantive criminal charge. The High Court’s order was based, the Bench said, on a “highly irresponsible” deprivation of personal liberties in Uttar Pradesh, where police officers and executive magistrates were using preventive powers to incarcerate individuals on the basis of arguably minor apprehensions. In *Chander Pal Singh* as well, the petitioner, a physically challenged Dalit advocate, had been arrested over a petty dispute with a neighbour. The Bench said that between May 2025 and April 2026, around 2,500 people were reportedly subjected to preventive detention proceedings in Ghaziabad, despite a 2021 State policy to guide the exercise of such powers.

The guidelines in response are commendable; if implemented appropriately, they could reduce the use of preventive incarceration in neighbourhood and property disputes; require executive magistrates to justify their decisions; encourage constitutional challenges to unlawful preventive detention; and generate appellate scrutiny of the compensation framework. They may also snap at the heels of magistrates who cite unspecified “communal tensions” to jail protesters and who impose prohibitively unaffordable bonds for release. Further, even if the ruling does not directly impinge on the detention of activist Sonam Wangchuk under the NSA, it critiques the idea of using the excuse of maintaining peace to silence dissent and reminds the state that it still has a responsibility to maintain peace with peace. The ruling may also apply to workers and activists recently detained in New Delhi if held under Sections 126 or 170 of the BNSS without valid grounds. That said, implementing the ruling will be difficult. The Bench said that compensation for unlawful detention can be recovered from the salary of the magistrate concerned and/or police officer following a disciplinary hearing. However, the executive has been historically reluctant to penalise its personnel. Second, executive magistrates are part of the State administration and their careers may depend on maintaining ‘peace’ as the State defines it. Addressing these barriers could reform preventive proceedings in India.

It is perhaps the first time that Congress leader and Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi has released his speech delivered at a meeting of Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) bloc leaders to the public. While his focus on building a united resistance to the Sangh-Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)’s assault on the constitutional foundations of the Indian republic, as well as on the liberties and livelihoods of millions of Indians, is welcome, a few constructive observations may be in order in the interest of building a truly powerful and sustained resistance.

This writer has attended all INDIA bloc meetings, including the formative gathering in Patna, Bihar, in June 2023 before the alliance adopted the INDIA name. Mr. Gandhi’s impassioned speech, delivered at a time when the BJP’s ‘double-engine’/National Democratic Alliance (NDA) governments span over 20 States and Union Territories, was both reassuring and somewhat concerning. While it would have resonated strongly at a Congress meeting, parts of it seemed somewhat discordant in a gathering of 23 parties representing diverse ideological streams united in defence of India’s sovereign, socialist, secular and democratic republic.

Mr. Gandhi is right in reminding us that the Congress became a movement of resistance after Purna Swaraj (complete independence) became the official goal of the Congress. The resolution, introduced in the 1927 Madras session, and adopted two years later in the 1929 Congress session in Lahore, did propel the Congress into the leading position in India’s freedom movement, with communists, socialists, and what is now known as the Phule-Ambedkar-Periyar stream serving as other prominent stakeholders. We must not however forget that the Purna Swaraj idea was first presented in the Ahmedabad session of the Congress in 1921 by two communist delegates, Maulana Hasrat Mohani and Swami Kumarananda. And Bhagat Singh and his comrades made a clear and bold ideological statement with the launch of the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association in 1928.

The battle against authoritarianism

The battle today is between the only ideological stream that stayed away from, and often opposed, the freedom movement and the diverse ideological currents that fought for and won India’s independence. The INDIA alliance represents a regrouping of these forces against the Hindutva school of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS)-BJP, which is seeking to reshape state institutions and the architecture of parliamentary democracy to advance its ideological agenda.

If the BJP gets a free hand in its push for ‘one nation, one party’, the Congress will suffer no less than other political parties; indeed, it has often proved more vulnerable. For all our



Dipankar Bhattacharya

General Secretary of the Communist Party of India (Marxist-Leninist) Liberation

glorious chapters from the history of the freedom movement, there is no accumulated ideological insulation or immunity for any party in the face of today’s all-out fascist offensive and ideological assault. The BJP itself is filled with leaders who were in the Congress not long ago. Even as Mr. Gandhi emphasised the need to resist the BJP, the Congress’s Chief Minister in Telangana was proudly invoking Hitler while defending Hyderabad’s controversial demolition drive.

If institutions are captured and the electoral system manipulated – from voter rolls to vote counting and the declaration of results – what option remains for the people who inherited a Constitution that envisions India as a sovereign, socialist, secular and democratic republic? Mr. Gandhi is absolutely right in arguing that the only answer is resistance – not sporadic or symbolic opposition, but sustained, broad-based and determined democratic resistance.

Towards a just republic

We can no longer afford policies that have proved disastrous for the country and the vast majority of its people. An economic model of crony capitalism that transfers all of India’s resources to a handful of corporations while impoverishing the masses and damaging the environment will have to go. A foreign policy that mortgages the strategic autonomy of India to the United States-Israel axis of aggression even as Indian sailors are killed by U.S. missiles needs immediate change. The assault on Adivasi land and forest rights, and attempts to rob them of their constitutional protections, must stop. A governance model that glorifies bulldozers and encounters while criminalising dissent has no place in a democratic republic. Equally, the ideology of cultural nationalism that defines nationhood through religious supremacy and exclusion must be rejected. Finally, an electoral system that sacrifices credibility and transparency needs urgent and comprehensive reform.

To be sure, such resistance is already underway. Farmers forced the Narendra Modi government to abandon the land acquisition ordinance in 2014 and, seven years later, repeal the three farm laws. The Shaheen Bagh-led movement against the Citizenship (Amendment) Act (CAA) in 2019 sparked nationwide opposition to what many saw as a threat to constitutional values. More recently, workers’ protests across north India against rising workloads and diminishing wages have highlighted growing economic distress. Student demonstrations, led by organisations ranging from the National Students’ Union of India (NSUI) or left student organisations such as the All India Students’ Association (AISA) and the Students’ Federation of India (SFI) or the new digital phenomenon called the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), are demanding accountability for the deepening crisis in the education and examination system. We must also acknowledge the price people

The INDIA bloc needs a new impetus rooted in democratic resistance, unity, humility and renewed political purpose

Technology drives India-France strategic convergence

It is a measure of the importance that Prime Minister Narendra Modi and French President Emmanuel Macron attach to the India-France relationship that they are meeting again in France, on the sidelines of the G-7 Summit in Evian (June 15-17), barely months after Mr. Macron’s visit to India for the India AI Impact Summit 2026 in New Delhi in February. During that visit, the two leaders jointly inaugurated the India-France Year of Innovation 2026.

In normal diplomacy, such announcements often take time to translate into action. It is therefore notable that Mr. Modi and Mr. Macron are already moving swiftly to advance bilateral technology cooperation. They jointly inaugurated the “Bharat Innovates” event in Nice (June 14-16), bringing together leading Indian start-ups and venture capital funds. Mr. Modi will then attend the VivaTech Summit in Paris on June 18, Europe’s largest technology and start-up event, underscoring the growing India-France technology partnership.

The new pillars of partnership

The India-French relationship is constantly evolving and is consequently being updated by the two leaders who are committed to the cause.

While the recently elevated Special Global Strategic Partnership has always included traditional areas such as defence, nuclear and space, it is the focus on tech and innovation that is now exciting for the relationship.

This focus will include cyberspace, Artificial Intelligence (AI), health care, sustainable development, creative economy, education and research. These are new facets of the evolving and dynamic relationship and will no doubt take



Mohan Kumar

Former Indian Ambassador to France and now Dean/Professor at O.P. Jindal Global University

Technology and innovation power the next phase of India-France ties

ties to greater heights. Tech and innovation has tremendous mutual advantages for both sides. France has some of the best state-of-the-art technology in aerospace, AI, robotics, biotech, health care, green tech and sustainable development, besides being a European hub for the digital economy.

It is not hard to see how India can not only benefit from access to technology in these areas but also bring its own added value in terms of frugal innovation, start-ups, digital public infrastructure and biotech, just to name a few. The possibilities are endless. It must be hoped that the two tech summits – “Bharat Innovates” and the “Vivatech” – will enable the private sector on both sides to come up with substantive collaborative arrangements.

Defence, space and Africa

The two leaders are also expected to take stock of the special strategic partnership. There are a number of dossiers which can benefit from their political and strategic guidance. The first is certainly the idea of the co-designing and co-production of defence platforms which must be expedited. Progress is also desirable in emerging areas such as small modular reactors, joint satellite development and human flight programmes.

The potential for Franco-Indian cooperation in Africa has not been fully exploited and this must get the attention of both sides. This becomes even more important in light of the postponement of the India-Africa Forum Summit (May 2026) due to the Ebola crisis in Africa. The two leaders will doubtless exchange views on the ongoing conflicts: in Ukraine and in Iran, which have

have paid for this resistance. More than 700 farmers died during the historic farmers’ protest at Delhi’s borders. Father Stan Swamy died in custody. Activists such as Surendra Gadling, Umar Khalid and Sharjeel Imam, among others linked to the Elgar Parishad and CAA protests, have been languishing for years. Workers and activists are facing imprisonment for demanding basic rights and fair wages. Activist Sonam Wangchuk appears to be a rare exception, having been released after months of detention under the National Security Act without any clear explanation. Journalists, too, have faced severe pressure, with Prabir Purkayastha among the few to secure relief after prolonged legal action.

Contrast this record of courage and perseverance among the people with the disturbing state of political parties, many of which are splitting or imploding under the pressure of intimidation or the lure of power. It is a reminder of how humble we must be when speaking of building resistance. The challenge before the INDIA bloc is to connect with these ongoing struggles, tap into the reservoir of public disillusionment, anger and aspiration, amplify demands for justice, and strengthen the collective struggle for democracy.

Reenergise the Opposition

The impact of two successive powerful struggles such as the equal citizenship campaign, the historic farmers’ movement, the message of the Bharat Jodo Yatra, and a series of encouraging electoral outcomes – from the BJP’s narrow escape in Bihar in 2020 to its defeats in West Bengal (2021) and Karnataka (2023) – created the ideal backdrop for the emergence of the INDIA coalition in 2023. Despite the exit of the Janata Dal (United) and the Rashtriya Lok Dal and the absence of electoral coordination in States such as West Bengal, Kerala and Punjab, the INDIA bloc came close to defeating the BJP-led NDA in 2024. The results in Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu – and, to some extent, Bihar – demonstrated INDIA’s electoral potential, raising the Congress tally to 100 seats and the alliance’s total to 234.

Since then, a series of electoral setbacks – beginning with the defeats in Maharashtra and Haryana in 2024 and Delhi in 2025 – has eroded the INDIA bloc’s strength and influence. These reverses, aided by multidimensional electoral frauds, have further tightened the BJP’s stranglehold over what remains of India’s electoral democracy. The INDIA bloc clearly needs a new impetus and a turnaround. Mr. Gandhi has a crucial dual role to play in this context – reenergising the Congress and facilitating the broader INDIA platform by ensuring mutual respect, trust and accommodation of parties with diverse histories and ideological inclinations. If India as a country can grow only on the basis of unity in, or rather through, diversity, the same also applies to INDIA as a political coalition.

adversely and disproportionately affected countries of the Global South.

Mr. Modi’s Europe visit (June 13-18, 2026) also includes a state visit to Slovakia, the first-ever visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Slovakia since its independence in 1993.

Watching the ‘D10 debate’

France, as the current chair of the G-7, will host the G-7 summit in Evian from June 15 to 17, 2026. It is difficult to imagine a G-7 summit without India being invited, and Mr. Modi’s participation is particularly important given the geopolitical turbulence of the present moment. United States President Donald Trump is also expected to attend it. While attention will naturally focus on the possibility of a Modi-Trump meeting, any interaction may not be a substantive one, given the G-7 atmospherics.

More important is the evolving role of the G-7 itself in global geopolitics. With the G-20 having lost some of its momentum in recent years, discussions have resurfaced about expanding the G-7 into a D10 – a grouping of 10 major democracies. Whether, and how soon, such a transformation materialises remains uncertain, but it is a development India will need to watch closely.

At the end of the day, two middle powers – India and France – which set great store by strategic autonomy, have a fundamental role to play in contributing to geopolitical stability and ensuring a smooth transition to a multipolar world. In that sense, Mr. Modi and Mr. Macron shoulder a significant responsibility.

The views expressed are personal

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Revised dress regulations

The move by the Indian Army to introduce new uniform regulations is commendable. Through these combined measures, the Indian Army cultivates a distinct institutional identity rooted in India’s own cultural fabric (June 15). These measures reflect the Army’s continued commitment to ensuring that the institutions, traditions and spaces where soldiers live, train and serve

increasingly embody India’s own heroes, values and national legacy while preserving the professionalism and heritage of the force.

R. Sivakumar,
Chennai

The constant invocation of the “colonial vestige” argument is becoming tiresome. This is the Army that has stood firm through wars, crises and security challenges, delivering when

the nation needed it most. Before lecturing institutions or changing traditions and symbols that have proven their worth, the government would do well to address its own shortcomings – from repeated controversies over NEET and infrastructure failures to concerns about electoral processes. Credibility is strengthened by performance, not rhetoric.

Vivek Gupta,
New Delhi

Portal closure

The admission application portal for the BS (Research) programme, Indian Institute of Science (IISc) closed on June 7 before the declaration of the IISER Aptitude Test (IAT) results – expected by June 20. Since admission through the IAT channel is based on rank, applicants were unable to provide this crucial information while applying. As admission processes generally commence only

after the declaration of qualifying examination results, many candidates reasonably assumed that applications could be submitted after the IAT results were announced. Owing to the unusual admission schedule and limited awareness that IAT details could be updated later, several deserving students may have missed the application deadline despite appearing for the examination. All applicants

had to pay a non-refundable fee. In view of these circumstances, the IISc must consider reopening the portal to enable eligible candidates to apply. Such a step would ensure equal opportunity for all applicants seeking admission through the IAT route.

Lalit Manohar K.,
Hyderabad

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

How T.N. severed religion, caste from politics

C. Joseph Vijay, actor and founder of the recently floated Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), assumed office as the new Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu last month. One cannot help but be reminded of how M.G. Ramachandran or more popularly known as MGR, also a highly successful actor, took charge as the Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu in 1977 and went on to win two more consecutive terms, until his death in 1987. He was the first actor-turned-CM in India.

However, apart from being successful film stars, there is hardly much in common between MGR, a Hindu of the Nair community of Kerala, and Mr. Vijay, a Tamil Christian. MGR's best-known co-star and successor, Jayalalithaa, who ruled the State for 16 years, was a Tamil Brahmin. Moreover, C.N. Annadurai, the first non-Congress CM of the State, his successor M. Karunanidhi, and his son M.K. Stalin were/are non-Brahmin Hindus.

As per Census figures, the electorate of Tamil Nadu comprises 88% Hindus and 6% Christians and Muslims each. It has regularly chosen leaders with varied religious and caste backgrounds without much fuss. How did this happen? And is it a replicable model?

A political history

The credit goes partly, among others, to the Dravidian movement whose genesis harkens to the 1920s/1930s. The Justice Party founded in 1916 by a group of non-Brahmin elite with the goal of ending Brahmin 'domination' in top government jobs succeeded in getting reservations for non-Brahmins as early as 1920. The 'self-respect movement' as well as the 'Dravidar Kazhagam' movement (DK) of E.V. Ramasamy (EVR), or 'Periyar' as he was known, avowed to create a society free of caste oppression and inequality, and became a strong oppositional force to the largely Brahmin priestly class in the State. Periyar's anti-Brahmin rhetoric



S. Ramasundaram

Retired IAS officer of the 1979 batch in Tamil Nadu, and writes on macro-economy, population and public health. Views are personal

often manifested in the form of inflammatory speeches against Brahmins besides leading to the desecration of Hindu deities.

The rise of the Congress Party during the freedom struggle led to the decline of the Justice Party by 1937, despite them forming a government four times since 1920. In 1949, the DK experienced a split with the breakaway faction led by C.N. Annadurai forming the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK). It came to power in 1967 and distanced itself from the anti-Brahmin and anti-religion ideas of Periyar. And while the DK has very little role in the politics of Tamil Nadu today, even after a century of his most active years, a Tamilian tends to either be a staunch supporter of Periyar or a vocal opponent of EVR – there is no middle ground.

Inclusive policies

The foundation laid by these parties and their inclusive social reforms over three decades led to the broad-basing of education among all communities and reservations in government jobs for non-Brahmin castes and, to a lesser extent, Dalits. The K. Kamaraj-led Congress government stressed free education for all. The 'Kalaiginar' Karunanidhi-led government focussed on uplifting the Dalit community through inclusive townships known as *Samathuva Puram* (Equality village). MGR's mid-day meal scheme resulted in an increase in girls enrolment, their retention in schools and resolve to work.

From the 1990s, the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK) government of Jayalalithaa and the DMK governments of Karunanidhi and later his son, Mr. Stalin, focussed on attracting FDIs in manufacturing, especially in the auto sector. As a result, Tamil Nadu has the highest proportion of urban population (almost 50%) in India, which is the engine driving its rapid economic growth and upward social mobility for all religions and castes.

Another remarkable achievement has been that around 42% of India's female factory workers are from Tamil Nadu while making up just 6% of the national population. Such a successful social reform is among the lasting contributions of the social justice and self-respect movement to Tamil society.

The role of films

An equally significant factor for the lack of caste or religious bias in the average Tamil Nadu voter is the role and influence of Tamil films and its actors. The Tamil film industry is reputed for rewarding only meritorious artists, without any consideration for religion or caste. While MGR, Jayalalithaa and now Mr. Vijay were/are stars, Karunanidhi was a script writer of many hit films, including some of MGR's. Between Karunanidhi (16 years), MGR (10 years) and Jayalalithaa (16 years), the film industry's connection with governance in Tamil Nadu has been as long as 42 years. By organising the 1,000th year of the Thanjavur Big Temple in a grand manner in 2010, Karunanidhi demonstrated that an atheist ruler need not be against the devout practising their faith.

Now, the TVK, Mr. Vijay's party, has managed to field and secure victories for a high number of MLAs who are Dalit and women.

In conclusion, the Tamil Nadu voter has almost always voted on considerations other than the religion or the caste of the candidate due to historical movements over the past century, and due to the positive influence of films produced by the secular Tamil film industry. Tamil Nadu has achieved something that required a great struggle in Europe in the 18th century, namely the separation of the Church and the Crown. Tamil movies and Tamil Nadu politics are an inseparable *jodi* that has largely been of benefit to the State socially and economically. For the same reason, it is not an easily replicable model for other States.

A highly-contested Rajya Sabha rejection

Rejection of Meenakshi Natarajan's nomination has exposed Congress faultlines

STATE OF PLAY

Ravi Reddy

The political after-shocks of the rejection of All India Congress Committee (AICC) Telangana in-charge Meenakshi Natarajan's Rajya Sabha nomination from Madhya Pradesh is reverberating across Hyderabad.

On June 9, the Returning Officer for the Rajya Sabha elections decided to invalidate Ms. Natarajan's nomination on the grounds of non-disclosure of a pending criminal case in her Form 26 affidavit.

The procedural dispute over an election affidavit has now spiralled into a narrative battle, exposing organisational deficiencies within the Congress, showcasing the Bharatiya Janata Party's (BJP) agility, and giving the Bharat Rashtra Samiti (BRS) fresh ammunition against the ruling Congress in the State. Despite approaching the top court and the Election Commission of India, Ms. Natarajan has not got any relief.

The case in question, stemming from a private complaint in 2022 in Telangana, does not accuse her directly of a criminal act but names her as a respondent for not acting against a party functionary. The Congress has maintained that such a matter, not amounting to an FIR or a criminal charge, did not merit disclosure. However, the BJP has framed the omission as a concealment of material information. This re-framing of a technical lapse as a question of transparency proved politically decisive.

More significantly, it highlighted the BJP's ability to harness local networks and institutional knowledge across States. Telangana BJP leaders reportedly moved with speed,



tracking down the complaint, verifying its legal standing, and presenting it before the Returning Officer. The episode underscores how political coordination and preparedness can intersect to yield outsized outcomes in tightly contested procedural routines.

Double whammy

For the Congress, the episode has been doubly damaging. First, it has exposed gaps in due diligence. That a senior leader's nomination could be jeopardised by a case linked to the very State she oversees points to a breakdown in internal vetting mechanisms. Such oversight reflects poorly on organisational discipline. Second, and perhaps more politically damaging, are allegations of internal sabotage. The claim, fuelled by remarks from a Madhya Pradesh Minister, has intensified factional fault lines in Telangana. Though evidence remains elusive, the very plausibility of an 'inside job' has damaged the party's credibility. Ms. Natarajan's tenure as AICC in-charge, marked by a reportedly firm and hands-on approach, had already generated unease among sections of the State leadership. The controversy has amplified those tensions.

Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy has sought to contain the fallout by framing the rejection as a politically motivated act. He alleged that the BJP

has shifted from 'vote theft' to 'seat theft'. At the same time, the Congress has drawn a distinction between criminal cases and procedural notices, arguing that the Returning Officer's interpretation stretches legal norms. Yet, these arguments have struggled to gain traction in the face of a more potent opposition line – that non-disclosure equals disqualification.

The BJP, for its part, has maintained that the process was entirely lawful, citing adherence to Supreme Court guidelines on disclosure requirements. Even if the BJP's operational role remains contested, its success in shaping the narrative is unmistakable.

The BRS has been the third beneficiary of this event. While not directly involved in the events leading to the rejection, it has seized the moment to question the Congress party's internal unity. BRS working president K.T. Rama Rao's allegation of backstabbing within the Congress has added to the perception of instability within the ruling party.

Beyond the immediate rhetoric, the episode raises broader questions about the ruling party's organisational robustness in Telangana. Since assuming power, the party has faced the dual challenge of governance and internal consolidation. In this context, the Natarajan episode becomes more than a legal dispute. It becomes a test of the Congress party's ability to manage crises, enforce accountability, and maintain internal cohesion. It has exposed vulnerabilities in the Congress' machinery, demonstrated the BJP's organisational capacity, and allowed the BRS to reinsert itself as a critical observer.

ravi.reddy@thehindu.co.in

Refugees are returning home but not for the right reasons

Data from the UN says that more refugees went back to their countries due to adverse conditions, while citizenship confirmations reduced

DATA POINT

The Hindu Data Team

Despite the fact that the estimated number of refugees fell marginally by 3% in 2025 to 4.16 crore, the recent report of the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR) for 2025 shows that certain groups continue to be affected. Of these, about 60 lakh (15%) are Palestinian refugees.

The drop was mainly driven by 1.47 crore returning to their countries, which is the second highest number of people returning since the UNHCR first reported the figures in 1965. This is reflected in the increase in the number of refugees attaining "solutions" for their predicaments (**Chart 4**).

However, the report noted that they returned to fragile situations due to adverse conditions and mounting pressures in the asylum countries. For instance, Iran and Pakistan had granted asylum to people from Afghanistan, who had been forced to escape war, violence and persecution. However, both countries have now introduced restrictive policies towards Afghans, due to which the two nations saw a notable decline in the number of people needing protection in 2025 (**Chart 2**). Nearly 19.5 lakh refugees from these two countries returned to Afghanistan.

Owing to governance and economic crises, Venezuela recorded the sharpest increase in refugees, people in refugee-like situations, and others in need of international protection, at 3%. Other countries that saw increases include South Sudan and Ukraine (**Chart 1**).

Chart 3 shows the flows of asylum applications. More than nine lakh persons applied for asylum in the U.S. Ukraine remains the country of origin for most applications (7 lakh). The number of stateless people who have had their nationality confirmed or who acquired citizenship declined in 2025.

No way home

The data for the charts were sourced from the Global Trends Report by the UN High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR)

CHART 1: Refugees, people in a refugee-like situation, and other people in need of international protection by country of origin (2016-2025)

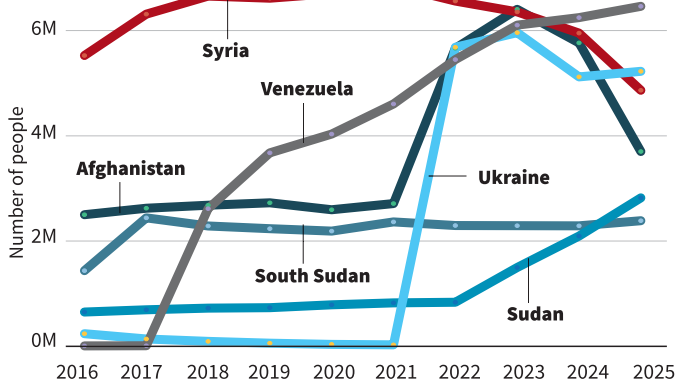


CHART 2: Refugees, people in a refugee-like situation and other people in need of international protection by country of asylum (2016-2025)

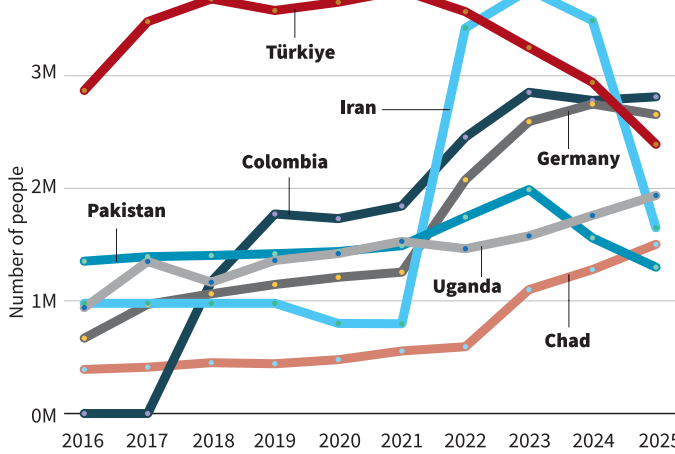


CHART 5: Number of stateless people who have had their nationality confirmed or who acquired citizenship (2014-2025)

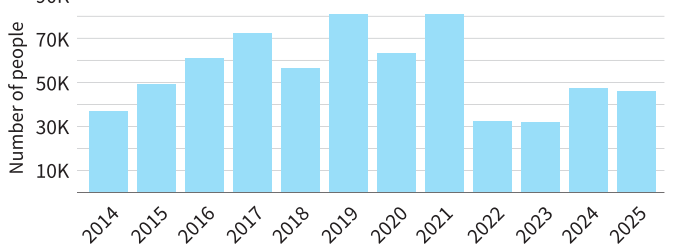


CHART 3: Number of people registering new individual asylum applications, recognised on a group basis or granted temporary protection in 2025

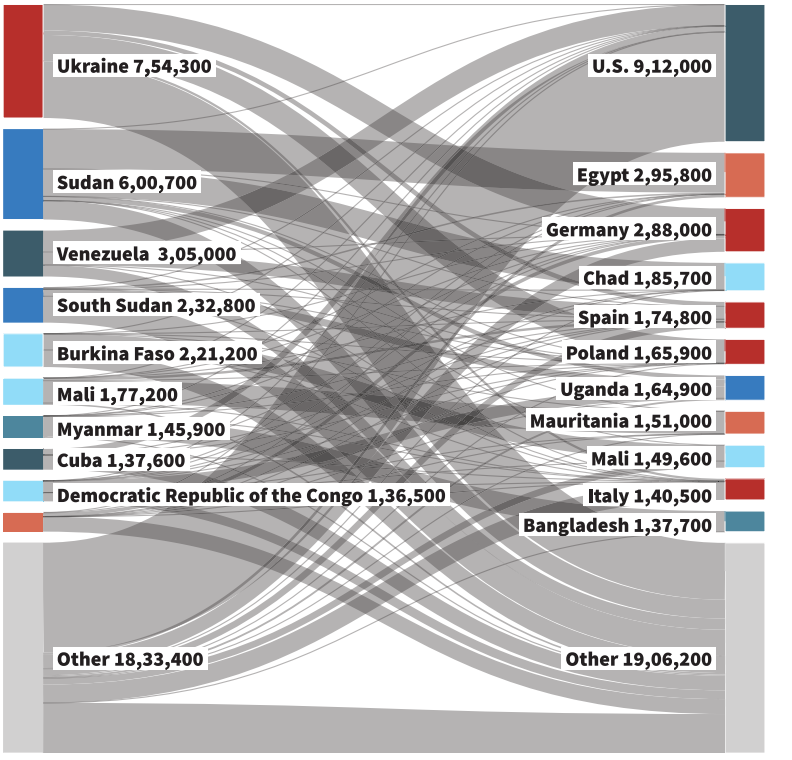
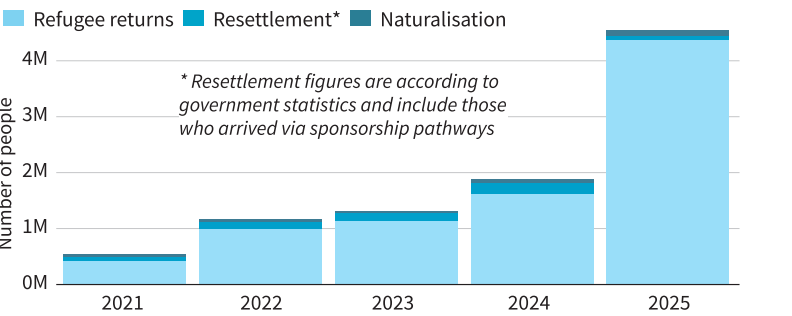


CHART 4: Refugees attaining "solutions" for their predicaments, a majority of which involved returns to their countries of origin, often due to adverse conditions



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu

FIFTY YEARS AGO JUNE 16, 1976

Survey to locate hidden treasure in Jaipur

New Delhi, June 15: A survey operation is on in Jaipur Fort to locate what is believed to be a hidden treasure lying in a secret chamber of the Maharaja's place for 250 years.

The survey has been undertaken on the basis of an ancient document which came to light recently, and which spoke of a treasure worth about Rs. 100 crores including jewellery valued at Rs. 32 crores having been hidden underground in the fort. The document said it belonged to the then Maharaja Jaisinghji of Jaipur. The Union Minister of State for Revenue and Banking Mr. Pranab Mukerjee said to-day that since the document after examination by experts of the national archives appeared to be genuine it was considered worthwhile to undertake the search operation though "there is no certainty whether the reported treasure is still in existence".

Mr. Mukerjee said it had been agreed with the owners of the Jaigarh fort that in the event of discovery of the treasure, it would be shared between the Government of India and them in accordance with the provisions of the Indian Treasure Trove Act, 1878. This Act has been made applicable to Rajasthan under a notification issued by the State Government.

He made it clear that the search was being carried out on the basis of an agreement with the owners of the fort.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO JUNE 16, 1926

Slavery in India

Mr. Lansbury asked whether the Government of India intended to deal with the form of slavery known as Kumis in Bengal and Chota Nagpur and whether the practice obtained over a large part of India and was condemned by the British population.

Earl Winterton replied that there was Kamiuti system in Bihar and that probably existed in other provinces under other names, but he would hesitate to agree that it obtained over a large part of India and he did not know the views of the British population on it. Legislation already existed in Bihar and Orissa to regulate this form of agreement and doubtless the local Government would take steps to render it more effective than appeared to be at present.

Amit Shah responsible for Trinamool ‘split’, merger bid, says Cong.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Monday accused Union Minister Amit Shah of masterminding the split in the Trinamool Congress, which is the third-largest Opposition party in the Lok Sabha, and of orchestrating the merger of the rebel group with the Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI) to engineer a two-thirds majority for the National Democratic Alliance (NDA) in the Lower House.

Congress general secretary (communications) Jai-ram Ramesh alleged that “decency, decorum, and devotion to constitutional values and principles remain vulnerable and threatened” every day that Mr. Shah continues in office.

“A desperate Union Home Minister – who is an absolute disgrace to the position once held by Sardar Patel – has taken Indian democracy to new lows in a shameless manner,” he said on X.

Terming the merger an “illegal breakaway”, Mr. Ramesh said that the NCPI was only a three-year-old political outfit that was hardly known. The Telugu Desam Party (TDP) and the Janata Dal (United), Mr. Ramesh said, should actually protest their “downgrade” through such “underhand tactics” and in such a “disgusting” manner, since the NCPI would now be the largest NDA ally.

No idea about merger, says Bengal MLA after Trinamool MPs’ move

We are principal Opposition party in the Bengal Assembly, says Ritabrata, a day after 20 MPs announced they will merge with regional party NCPI

Sobhana K. Nair
Sreeparna Banerjee
NEW DELHI

Indicating further fragmentation in the Trinamool Congress, the rebel factions of the party – one in the Lok Sabha and the other in the West Bengal Assembly – have spoken in different voices.

While the Leader of the Opposition in the State Assembly, Ritabrata Banerjee, who claims the support of 65 MLAs, said the Legislature Party had “no idea” about merging with the Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI), their colleagues in the Lok Sabha had already announced such a move.

On Sunday night, 20 MPs elected on the Trinamool symbol informed the Lok Sabha Speaker that they had merged with the NCPI, a registered regional party. Later, speaking to reporters, Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar, who is leading the faction, said that this group “will collaborate” with the National Democratic Alliance (NDA).

Mr. Banerjee, meanwhile, struck a different note, insisting on playing the role of the Opposition. Speaking to *The Hindu* on Monday, Mr. Banerjee said: “We are the principal Opposition party in the West



Ritabrata Banerjee said the Legislature Party had ‘no idea’ about merging with the Nationalist Citizens Party of India. FILE PHOTO

Bengal Assembly.” On whether the rebel MLAs would merge with the NCPI, he said no such decision had been taken.

Mr. Banerjee later told reporters in Kolkata that he had learnt about the decision of the 20 MPs to merge with the NCPI through the media. “It is their decision; their collective has taken such a decision. As far as our collective is concerned, we have no such idea,” he said. He added that while not all 65 MLAs were present in Kolkata, many met and consulted. “As far as the Legislature Party is concerned, we do not know any such thing,” he said.

For a merger, the support of two-thirds of the Legislature Party in Parliament as well as the As-

sembly is required. With Mr. Banerjee’s bloc refusing any such move, it will be difficult for Ms. Dastidar’s faction to press its claim on the party and symbol.

Meanwhile, the Trinamool faction aligned with party founder Mamata Banerjee remained silent on any action against the 20 MPs. On Sunday, Trinamool MPs Sagarika Ghose and Kirti Azad had submitted a letter to Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla before the 20 rebel leaders met him. The letter urged the Speaker not to recognise or grant separate status to any rebel faction. The letter from party national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee said the Trinamool was a “single, indivisible political party”.

Merger may allow rebels to vote in LS prior to any ruling on disqualification

NEWS ANALYSIS

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

The decision made by the rebel MPs of the Trinamool Congress to merge with the little-known Nationalist Citizens Party of India might not be a foolproof way of avoiding disqualification under the anti-defection law, but it can allow them to vote in the Lok Sabha, pending a decision from the Speaker in case the party files a petition seeking their disqualification.

With sources in the government indicating that the Centre is likely to bring the Constitution (One Hundred and Thirty First Amendment) Bill, 2026, or the Delimitation Bill, as early as the Monsoon Session of Parliament, which is likely to begin in mid-July, it becomes crucial that this bloc, which has promised support to the Na-



Political shake-up: Rebel Trinamool MPs meeting Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla at his residence in New Delhi on Sunday. ANI

tional Democratic Alliance (NDA) gets to vote when the said Bills are taken up. In April, the government had fallen short of the two-thirds majority required for its passage.

On Sunday, the rebel Trinamool camp had approached Speaker Om Birla, submitting the names of 20 MPs who make up two-thirds of the Trinamool Parliamentary Party in the House, that they would be merging with the NCPI.

“Under the 10th Schedule, only the original political party can merge with another party, and thereafter the MPs or MLAs can make a claim that their original party has merged, and they agree to that merger, and have become members of that party. Thus, MPs alone cannot merge with any other party. However, till the Speaker gives any ruling, these MPs can vote in favour of any Bills which are taking

up as part of the legislative business,” according to former Lok Sabha Secretary General and constitutional law expert P.D.T. Achary.

The Mamata Banerjee-led Trinamool is yet to file a disqualification petition.

The move to merge helps the rebel bloc avoid a long process, which would have ensued in case they had approached the Election Commission, and staked claim to be the “real Trinamool Congress”, especially in view of the Supreme Court judgment in the case of the Shiv Sena’s split in Maharashtra.

The rebels seem to have chosen to merge with the NCPI to secure immediate parliamentary recognition as a separate bloc rather than fighting a long-drawn symbol battle as, under Para 15 of the Symbols Order, the Election Commission relies on the strict legal framework of the 1971 *Sadiq Ali* ruling.

Kakoli seeks Kalyan’s expulsion from LS

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

In a letter to Speaker Om Birla, Lok Sabha member Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar, who is leading the rebel faction of Trinamool Congress MPs, has sought the expulsion of party chief whip and Mamata Banerjee loyalist Kalyan Banerjee for “repeated verbal

abuse and misogynistic remarks directed” at her and other women members during the sittings of the House.

In her letter dated June 10, the MP from Barasat constituency in West Bengal said the complaint was a follow-up to an earlier one dated May 28 and sought immediate intervention and action against

Mr. Banerjee. Ms. Dastidar said Mr. Banerjee had, on several occasions, used “objectionable, disrespectful and inappropriate language against her and other women members during parliamentary proceedings.” She said the conduct formed part of a recurring pattern of “personal attacks, intimidation and misogynistic com-

ments that went beyond the limits of robust political disagreement and entered the realm of personal abuse and harassment.”

Ms. Dastidar said the conduct had not only caused personal anguish but had created an atmosphere that discouraged the free participation of women in parliamentary proceedings.

ED questions Abhishek for 11 hours in primary school recruitment scam case

Senjuti Sengupta
KOLKATA



Abhishek Banerjee arriving at the Enforcement Directorate (ED) office on Monday. PTI

The Enforcement Directorate questioned Trinamool Congress general secretary Abhishek Banerjee in Kolkata for 11 hours on Monday, in connection with the alleged primary school jobs scam case.

Mr. Banerjee arrived at the ED’s CGO Complex office at 11 a.m. in response to a summons in a money laundering probe linked to alleged irregularities in the recruitment of primary school teachers. He left the ED office at night.

“I was questioned for over eight hours yesterday [on Sunday] and for 11 hours today [Monday]. This is a 2023 case and I have appeared before the agency 10-12 times. I won’t say whether there is a political pressure or not. The less said of the BJP, the bet-

ter. On the one side, they break our party and indulge in post-poll violence. Even if you slit my throat, I won’t cower down...I will appear before the agency if they summon me even in the future.” Mr. Banerjee said, while leaving the ED office.

Officials said Mr. Banerjee was questioned over the alleged money trail in the scam. “He was asked

questions regarding some financial documents, digital records, and statements of other accused to trace the alleged proceeds of crime. Investigators sought details about who handled the funds, how they were moved across accounts and entities, and whether these transactions were layered to conceal their origin,” said an officer on the request of anonymity.

The ED questioning came a day after Mr. Banerjee was quizzed by the West Bengal CID in connection with the alleged forgery of Trinamool Congress MLAs’s signatures on documents related to the appointment of the Leader of the Opposition in the State Assembly.

He is also scheduled to appear before the CID again on Tuesday in connection with the same case.

Bhagwat dismisses Priyank letter seeking ‘transparency’ in RSS

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) chief Mohan Bhagwat has brushed aside Karnataka Home Minister Priyank Kharge’s call for greater transparency from the organisation, saying that the demand is “driven by politics rather than genuine concerns over accountability”.

The controversy began after Mr. Kharge wrote an open letter to the RSS chief on June 13, seeking details about the organisation’s registration status, sources of funding, income, expenditure, and assets. Arguing that an organisation with a nation-wide presence and thousands of daily *shakhas* should be subject to public scrutiny, the Congress leader said the RSS should adhere to the same disclosure norms applicable to NGOs, companies, and religious institutions.

Asked about the letter during an RSS centenary outreach programme in Thrissur on Sunday, Mr. Bhagwat said he saw no reason to respond to the demand and dismissed it as politically motivated.

‘Not secretive’

“I don’t need to respond. There are so many unregistered things functioning in the country. We are not secretive; we work openly and people know what we do. We are used to such allegations. Those who seek government funds require registration,” he said, adding that even Hindu Dharma is not a registered entity.

He also maintained that the Sangh’s activities were conducted publicly.

The RSS chief noted that courts and tax authorities had recognised the RSS as a “body of individuals” and granted it income-tax exemptions.

Cockroach party founder manhandled, slapped during protest in Jaipur; two youth detained

The Hindu Bureau
JAIPUR

Cockroach Janta Party founder Abhijeet Dipke was allegedly manhandled and slapped during a protest in Jaipur on Monday, triggering chaos and a brief struggle at the venue. The police detained two youth in connection with the incident.

The demonstration, attended by a large number of youth, was organised at Shaheed Smarak to protest over the issues of the alleged National Eligibility-

cum-Entrance (NEET) paper leak, unemployment and corruption.

When Mr. Dipke arrived at the protest site and was being carried on shoulders of supporters, some miscreants in the crowd allegedly manhandled him, slapped him multiple times and attempted to pull him down. Mr. Dipke’s supporters caught hold of the accused and assaulted them before the police intervened.

As tempers ran high, Mr. Dipke appealed to the protesters not to assault the in-



Abhijeet Dipke

dividuals involved in the attack. The CJP founder said physical attacks were a sign of “fear and cowardice”. “I am a follower of Gandhi and Ambedkar,

and I will keep fighting this battle with peace and love,” he said.

‘Tactic to threaten CJP’

In a video message released on his X account, Mr. Dipke urged his supporters not to get distracted from the demand for Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan’s resignation. He said the attack was a tactic to threaten the CJP and divert attention from the real issues, and added: “To the haters, I want to say ‘get well soon!’”

During the protest, many youngsters carried banners and placards and raised slogans demanding Mr. Pradhan’s resignation over alleged irregularities in major examinations.

Addressing the gathering, Mr. Dipke criticised the handling of education-related issues and questioned the remarks of a Rajasthan Minister who had described the NEET paper leak as “no big deal”.

He cited the collapse of a government school building in Jhalawar, in which seven students were killed.



GOVERNMENT OF INDIA-DEPARTMENT OF SPACE CONSTRUCTION & MAINTENANCE GROUP, SDSC –SHAR
SRIHARIKOTA-524124

Brief E-TENDER NOTICE

No: SHAR: CMG CIVIL:MAINT-E-PT-04/26-27Dt: 11.06.2026

On behalf of President of India, Item Rate tenders are invited through e-tendering for following works;

Name of Work	Tender No	Estimate Cost
AMC for Civil & PH works in PHC-II area, SDSC for year 2026-2027 & 2027-2028 (Two years).	T/C-26-007	₹ 227.54 Lakhs

Tender documents can be downloaded up to **29.06.2026, 14:30** hrs. For eligibility criteria and other details, interested tenderers may please refer to the detailed bilingual (Hindi-English) Notice Inviting Tenders (NIT) on the website <https://www.isro.gov.in/Tenders.html> and tender free view at <https://www.tenderwizard.com/isro>

Sd/- GROUP HEAD, CMG/ SDSC SHAR



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(DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE, GOVT. OF KERALA)
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(Telephone No. 0471-2945600)
E-mail : edrugs.kmscl@kerala.gov.in,
website : www.kmscl.kerala.gov.in, CIN No. U24233KL2007SGC021616

No.KMSCL/ED/17/2026**Date : 12.06.2026**

E-TENDER NOTICE

Online bids are invited from **manufacturers/direct importers/ loan licensees** on behalf of Department of Health, Govt of Kerala for the procurement of drugs for the year 2026-27.

Sr. No.	Tender No. and Date	No. of items
1.	KMSCL/ED/VIT-A/RC/2026/016 Dtd. 12/06/2026	1

The last date and time of online uploading of tenders will be 24.06.2026, 5.00 pm. The date and time of opening of Technical bid will be 29.06.2026, 11.30 am. Tender documents can be downloaded and submitted online through the e-tender portal **www.etenders.kerala.gov.in**.

(Sd/-) MANAGING DIRECTOR (Tender Inviting Authority)



अखिल भारतीय आयुर्विज्ञान संस्थान, गोरखपुर
All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Gorakhpur
(स्वायत्त एवं विशिष्टतः कार्यवाहक संसद्गण भारत सरकार द्वारा स्थापित एक स्वायत्त संस्थान)
(An autonomous organization under the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of India)
Website-<https://aiimsgorakhpur.edu.in>

NON-FACULTY APPOINTMENTS

Offline applications from eligible Indian citizens/other citizens as permissible under the applicable Act/Rules are invited to fill up following **Non-Faculty (Group A)** various posts on **Direct Recruitment Basis** at All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Gorakhpur (Uttar Pradesh):

Sr. No.	Name of the post	Group	Pay level (7th CPC)	No. of Vacancies					
				UR	OBC	SC	ST	EWS	Total
1.	Child Psychologist	A	Level 10	1	-	-	-	-	1
2.	Clinical Psychologist	A	Level 10	1	-	-	-	-	1
3.	Medical Officer (AYUSH)	A	Level 10	3 (Ayurveda-01, Homeopathy-01, Yoga & Naturopathy-01)	-	-	-	-	3

The above vacancies are provisional and subject to variation. The Executive Director, AIIMS, Gorakhpur reserves the right to change the number of the vacancies including reserved vacancies as per the Govt. of India rules/circulars. **Application form along with Brief and PowerPoint formats are available on institute's website www.aiimsgorakhpur.edu.in**

All the applicants are advised to check AIIMS, Gorakhpur website **www.aiimsgorakhpur.edu.in** on Regular basis for any further updates.

Sd/-
Executive Director
AIIMS Gorakhpur











A CH-CHE

Business

INBRIEF



Investors upbeat as clarity emerges on U.S.-Iran deal

Indian investors were elated as clarity emerged regarding the US-Iran deal, leading to decline in Brent crude prices. Sensex jumped 736.38 points, or 0.97%, to settle at 76,264.33. During the day, it zoomed 1,293.12 points, or 1.71%, to 76,821.07. Nifty surged 231 points, or 0.98%, to end at 23,853.90. During the day, the benchmark rallied 388.5 points, or 1.64%, to 24,011.40. “With core inflation firming to 3.9% and RBI raising its FY27 CPI forecast to 5.1%, inflation dynamics remain a key monitorable despite the near-term relief from softer crude prices. Going forward, investors will closely track the formal signing of the U.S.-Iran agreement, crude oil price trends, FII flow dynamics and evolving inflation expectations for further market direction,” said Siddhartha Khemka - Head of Research, Wealth Management, Motilal Oswal Financial Services.

IRDAI moots changes to key norms governing insurers

Insurance regulator IRDAI is proposing amendments to registration regulations for insurance companies with the aim of enhancing ease of doing business, simplification of regulatory processes, reduction of compliance costs, enhancement of operational clarity and facilitation of capital infusion. The changes relate to eligibility criteria for Indian as well as foreign promoters; foreign investment safeguards, special purpose vehicles (SPVs), approval for transfer of shares, amalgamation of insurance companies with non-insurance companies, processing fees for applications, name of insurance companies; and forms and application procedures. On amendments proposed in definitions relating to foreign promoter, Indian promoter and SPV, IRDAI said the proposed amendments seek to ensure consistency and put in place safeguard mechanisms in view of the increase in limit of FDI to 100%.

‘SEBI move to group AMC staff pay a course correction’

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

Market experts backed SEBI’s move to water-down executive remuneration disclosure norms for AMC staff stating it was a ‘correction of overregulation.’

Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)’s had proposed disclosure of salaries of high earning staff in mutual fund firms as a group would suffice, a departure from the current individual disclosure.

The decision was taken after industry bodies reached out to SEBI stating norm had to be relaxed considering staff privacy and the information being less significant to retail investors, according to the consultation paper.

As per March 20, 2026



Unit holders do not require the granular disclosure shareholders would need.

Master Circular on MFs this benchmark was ₹1.02 crore in annual income and the top 10 staff earnings.

Ashish Gupta, an industry professional, said unit holders were part of a trust structure and hence, do not need the granular disclosure shareholders would require. He agreed

U.S. SC rejects TCS appeal in \$168-mn trade secrets case

Reuters
WASHINGTON

The U.S. Supreme Court turned away on Monday a bid by India-based Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) to overturn a \$168 million award won against it by DXC Technology for allegedly stealing trade secrets related to life-insurance software.

Tata had appealed after a lower court upheld a judge’s decision to set the award at \$56 million in compensatory damages and \$112 million in punitive damages to Ashburn, Virginia-based DXC.

Passenger vehicle wholesales rise 27% in May to 4.39 lakh

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Passenger vehicles recorded wholesales of 4.39 lakh units, a growth of 27.3% year-on-year.

As many as 0.71 lakh three-wheelers were sold, in May, up 31.1% while the offtake of two-wheelers was 19.02 lakh, representing a growth of 14.8%, according to the data released by the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM).

Rajesh Menon, director general, SIAM said, “Passenger vehicles, three-wheelers and two-wheelers recorded the highest-ever sales of May in 2026,

WPI inflation jumps to 9.7% in May on surging fuel prices

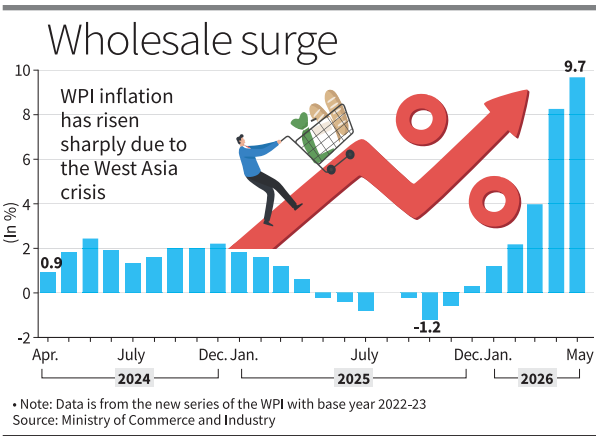
Govt. releases new series of Wholesale Price Index with an updated base year of 2022-23 along with new producer price indices in line with global best practices and IMF recommendations

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Inflation at the wholesale level rose to 9.7% in May 2026, primarily driven by surging prices of crude oil, natural gas, mineral oils and to a smaller extent, manufactured products, according to official data.

The Ministry of Commerce and Industry on Monday released the new series of the Wholesale Price Index (WPI) with an updated base year of 2022-23 and wider ambit of goods measured. Due to the base year update, a historical comparison further back than April 2024 is not available. The May 2026 inflation rate is the highest since at least then.

Along with the new WPI, the Commerce Ministry also released the first editions of its Output Producer Price Index (OPPI), Trial Input Producer Price



Index (IPPI), and Service Producer Price Index (Service PPI) of seven services – Banking, Securities Transaction, Insurance, Management of Pension Funds, Railways, Passenger Air, and Telecom.

WPI to be phased out
The government also said that the Producer Price Index (PPI) will replace the WPI in five years. “Considering the wide

usage of WPI in price escalation clauses, this index will be released for five years from the date of its release, along with PPI, and will be discontinued thereafter,” the Commerce Ministry said in its release. “This would give sufficient time to users to switch from WPI to PPI.”

It added that the transition from WPI to PPI is in line with the global best practices adopted by ad-

vanced economies and the recommendations of the IMF.

The surge in the WPI in May 2026 was driven overwhelmingly by soaring fuel prices that month as a result of the West Asia crisis.

Inflation in the crude oil and natural gas category jumped to 61.5% in May 2026, from 56.3% in the previous month. While this is a reflection of the elevated global oil and gas prices, it is also a result of a low base, since the new series of the WPI shows prices in this category contracted by 15.5% in May last year.

Similarly, inflation in the mineral oils category accelerated to 49.8% in May 2026 from 40.7% in April. Here, too, prices had contracted in May last year.

The WPI shows that inflation in the manufacturing and food segments also quickened in May 2026, albeit not as quickly as for fuel.

Sarvam raises \$234 mn in funding round from HCLTech, others

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Sarvam, a sovereign AI firm, on Monday said it had raised \$234 million in the first close of its \$300 million Series B at a post-money valuation of \$1.5 bil-

lion. HCLTech and Bessemer Venture Partners invested in the round, with continued support from existing investors Khosla Ventures and Peak XV Partners, Sarvam said in a statement. HCLTech would invest

\$150 million as the lead strategic investor in this round.

HCL’s investment in Sarvam marked a significant step toward building the country’s globally competitive AI ecosystem, CEO & MD Vijayakumar said.

Press Trust of India
MUMBAI

The rupee strengthened 60 paise to settle at 94.58 against the U.S. dollar on Monday as global crude oil prices dropped sharply after U.S. President Donald

With peace deal in sight, oil prices slip to lowest in 3 months

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

Benchmark Brent Crude futures slipped to a more than three-month low on Monday with a peace deal between Iran and the United States in sight – putting an end to more than a 100 days of hostilities in West Asia that led to the closure of the Strait of Hormuz.

During Monday’s trade, Brent Crude futures (August) tumbled approximately 5.47%, or about \$4.77, to \$82.56 per barrel.

U.S. West Texas Intermediate (WTI) also slipped about 6.1% to \$79.71 per barrel on Monday.

Unrelatedly, addressing reporters at the bi-weekly briefing about the situation in West Asia, Sujata Sharma, Joint-Secretary at the Union Petroleum Ministry, informed that State-owned oil-marketing companies’ under-recovery on petrol and diesel too had come down to ₹3 per litre and ₹27 per litre respectively. OMCs continue to incur



Crude prices could take up to a year to normalise to pre-war levels. REUTERS

an under-recovery of about ₹700 per cylinder on LPG cylinders meant for domestic consumption.

Analysts opine that complete normalisation of prices may take time.

“Beyond the immediate price action, crude prices could take six months to a year to normalise to pre-war levels given that almost 10-11 million barrels per day of production has been shut in West Asia besides which some facilities have suffered damages,” said Prashant Vasisht, Senior Vice President and Co-Group Head, Corporate Ratings at ICRA.

Rupee strengthens 60 paise to settle at 94.58 against U.S. dollar

Trump announced that the U.S. and Iran finalised a deal to end the war.

A surge in the domestic equity markets and a weaker U.S. dollar further drove the local unit, forex traders said. At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee

opened at 94.70 against the U.S. dollar and traded in the range of 94.45-94.77. Eventually, it settled at 94.58, up 60 paise from its previous close. The rupee jumped 67 paise to close at 95.18 against the green-back on Friday.

APPOINTMENT

NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF RURAL DEVELOPMENT & PANCHAYATI RAJ
(An Organisation of the Ministry of Rural Development, Govt. of India)
Rajendranagar, Hyderabad-500030

Recruitment of Chair Professor on 'Rural Labour' in honour of Late Shri S.R.Sankaran
NIRDPR invites applications for Chair Professor constituted in honour of Late Shri S.R. Sankaran, an eminent civil servant and acclaimed rural development administrator. The Chair Professor should be a person of National/International Eminence either from India or abroad who can guide and inspire research, consultations and also networks with academicians, administrators, political parties and civil society groups. He/she should possess qualifications normally required for a Senior Professor in a Central University.

Those who applied with reference to **Advt. No.07/2024 & 18/2025** need not apply again.

For Job profile, online submission of application and other details please visit: **http://career.nirdpr.in/**

Last date for submission of online application is **15/07/2026**.

Advt.No.08/2026 **File No: SRSC/16/1** **Comp.no. 5100**

Sd/-
Assistant Director
Administration (Section-I)

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NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Tender No.	Material Description	Due date
262713 001445	Steaming (Non-Coking) Coal in Bulk (Imported) with 4200 GAR on Stock and Sale Basis	20.06.2026

Corrigendum if any will be issued in TNPL Website and NIC Portal only. Detailed Terms & conditions are available in tender document at our websites : **www.tnpl.com/** **https://ntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app**

DIPR/2063/Tender/2026 **TNPL - Maker of bagasse based eco-friendly Paper**

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Website :- **www.rajasthan.gov.in/ada**, Tel.No. :- **0145-2627748-2627749**
जमका :- अजमेर/ए.2/राजनीति/2026-27/एडकाज 22734586 दिनांक :- 09/06/2026

E-TENDER - 08/2026-27

Bids for various work amounting Rs. 943-16 Lacs are invited from interested bidders for up to 22.07.2026, 6:00 pm. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on procurement portal (**http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in**) & (**http://sppp.raj.nic.in**) **http://www.urban.rajasthan.gov.in/ada** departmental website.

UBN No. : AJD2627WSOB00055 - 00056
Raj.Samwad/C/26/4869 **Executive Engineer**

Office of the Additional Chief Engineer (Project) PHED Ajmer
Qtr. No. II/2, PHED Colony, Vaishali Nagar, near RICO Watch Factory, Ph. No. 0145-2640265,
email: **acepajmer@gmail.com**, **acepajm.phed@rajasthan.gov.in**
S.No. F(ACE/Proj)/AJAR-JJM /2026-27/1489 Date: 10/06/2026

CORRIGENDUM NO. 6
NIB Code:- PHE2526A6441 & UBN No. PHE2526WLB13856
In continuation to this office NIT No. 03/2025-26 issued vide letter no. 2436-2491 dated 11.02.2026. The following amendment are hereby notified:-

S.N.	Description	As per original NIT & Corrigendum 5	As per this corrigendum
1	Date & time for downloading of tender document	13.02.2026 at 10:00 AM to 11.06.2026 up to 06:00 PM	13.02.2026 at 10:00 AM to 09.07.2026 up to 6:00 PM
2	Date & time for online submission of tender	From 24.02.2026 at 10:00 AM to up to 11.06.2026 at 6:00 PM	Up to 09.07.2026 at 06:00 PM
3	Date & time of physical submission of tender fee, RISL charges and EMD	12.06.2026 at 01:00 PM	Up to 10.07.2026 at 01:00 PM
4	Date & time of opening of technical bid	12.06.2026 at 03:00 PM	Up to 10.07.2026 at 03:00 PM

All other terms and conditions shall remain same as mentioned in tender document.

(K.K. Agarwal)
Additional Chief Engineer (Project) PHED, Ajmer
DIPRC/10387/2026

KERALA STATE ELECTRICITY BOARD LIMITED - Expression Of Interest
O/o the Chief Engineer (REES & PED),
Vidyuthi Bhavanam, Thiruvananthapuram.
Notice inviting Expression Of Interest (EOI) for Repowering of the existing 2.025MW (22SKWx 9 nos), WIND FARM of KSEB, to SHW at KANJIKODE under TBCEB model
E tender ID 2026_KSEB_855306_1
Last date & Time of submission of (EOI) 10-08-2026, 03.00 pm. The EOI documents and other details may be downloaded from the website **https://etenders.kerala.gov.in**.
Email/Phone **cerees@kseb.in-0471-2514336**
Visit **www.etenders.kerala.gov.in** and **www.kseb.in** Ref: PR/MC/1/F390/2026

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, साठनिठिठि वृत्त चूरू
जमका - 375 दिनांक :- 09.06.2026
ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 02 / 2026-27
इसक निविदादाताओं से जिला चूरू में सड़क कार्य व आरक्षी कार्य (निगमनासार दोष निवारण व सुधार अर्थात्) कार्य हेतु अनुमानित लागत राशि को 950.57 लाख की ई-निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। कार्य के निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 07.07.2026 सांघ 6.00 बजे तक ऑनलाइन अपलोड करना आवश्यक होगा। जका निविदा से सम्बंधित विवरण राज्य सरकार के प्रोक्योरमेंट पोर्टल **http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in**, **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** व विभागीय वेबसाइट **http://pwed.rajasthan.gov.in** पर देखे जा सकते हैं।
NIB No- PW/D2627A0947
UBN No- 1- PW/D2627WLB0864105
2- PW/D2627WSOB084164
DIPRC/10166/2026 **अधीक्षण अभियन्ता सा.नि.वि. चूरू जका**

Rajasthan Co-operative Dairy Federation Limited
"SARAS SANKUL" J. L. N. MARG, JAIPUR - 302017, Ph. No. 202501-08 : District 0141-2720209
Email : **rcdf@rajasthan.gov.in**

No. :- RCDF/EDP/F.8(284)/2026-27/12786-823 Dated :- 10/06/2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

E-tenders are invited for "Selection of Service Provider for Rajasthan Co-operative Dairy Federation (RCDF) for "Upgradation of existing ERP to ERP 2.0 for Milk Unions with Real time monitoring & AI and AMC of 2 years, Upgradation of existing ERP to ERP 2.0 for Cattle Feed Units with Real time monitoring & AI and AMC of 2 years, Design, Development and Implementation of ERP for Additional Units of RCDF including RCDF Head office with AMC of 2 Year and ERP Implementation for New Milk Unions and New Cattle Feed Units with AI and AMC of 2 Years" from ERP solution Providers". Other details can be obtained from **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in**, **www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in** i.e. spp portal and our website: **www.sarasmlfcd.rajasthan.gov.in** (UBN No: CDF2627SLOB080381 and Tender ID (2026_RCDF_566434_1)
Raj.Samwad/C/26/4867 **General Manager (P&A)**
जिला नॉट सॉल-जका

BANGALORE ELECTRICITY SUPPLY COMPANY LIMITED
(Wholly Owned by Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
(CIN-U04010KA2002SGC030438)

NOTIFICATION INVITING TENDER (NIT) (Through KPP portal)

No: BESCOM/CGM(Proj)/DGM-1/AGM-1/BC-14/26-27/87
The Notification for Inviting Tender was issued vide No. CYS-51 on 13-05-2026 in Prajavani and The Hindu newspaper is modified as under:
Tender Enquiry No: BESCOM/2026-27/EL/WORK_INDENT1100 (1)Availability of Bid documents: **18-06-2026** onwards. (2) Last date for submission of bid Queries: **20-06-2026** before 17:00 Hrs. (3) Pre-Bid meeting: **30-06-2026 @ 11:30 Hrs. Venue of Pre-Bid meeting : O/o Chief General Manager (Ele), 4th Floor, Project Section, B Block, Corporate office, BESCOM, K. R Circle, Bangalore- 560 001.** (4) Last date for bid submission: **20-07-2026 @ 15:00 Hrs.** (5)Opening of Technical Bids: **21-07-2026 @ 15:30 Hrs.**
The bid documents can be downloaded and necessary assistance can be obtained through the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal (KPPP) from the website. **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in**
KPP Portal Help Desk: Phone No: **+91-8046010000 +91-8068948777** E-mail: **support@eprochelpdesk.com**
Aspiring bidders needs to be registered on Karnataka Public Procurement Portal (KPPP). Bidders can take the assistance from the KPP during office working hours.

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Record daily jump in Ebola cases in Congo pushes death toll to 181



Myanmar's ex-junta chief kicks off first China trip as civilian President



G7 leaders gather in France under shadow of Trump's tariff threats



China rejects security report, says its military growth aids world peace



Russian strikes across Ukraine kill 11, famed monastery in Kyiv catches fire

'Israel won't withdraw troops from Lebanon, Syria, Gaza'

Hegseth denies U.S. facing shortage in munitions stockpile

Bangladesh PM's Adviser 'stopped' at Delhi airport

U.K. govt. bans social media for children under 16

Sport

Gurnoor — a choice driven by instinct and beyond the numbers



Ashley Sessa and Madeleine Zimmer were on the score-sheet for the USA.

The winner of the Nations Cup will be promoted to the elite Pro league, from which India was relegated last season.

TUNISIAN HERITAGE

Sweden's Yasin doesn't celebrate goal against his father's country



AP After he opened the scoring in Sweden's 5-1 win over Tunisia in the World Cup, Yasin Ayari chose not to celebrate. Instead, he raised his hands in apology. The 22-year-old was born in Solna, Sweden, to a Tunisian father, Azzouz Ayari. Yasin was given the chance to play for Tunisia ahead of the 2022 World Cup, but he declined.

SPOTLESS

Continuing tradition, Japanese fans clean up stadium post match



GETTY IMAGES Japan fans left the stands spotless after their World Cup opener against the Netherlands in Texas on Sunday, saying it was "Japanese culture" to tidy up after themselves. Spectators stayed behind to make sure they left the stadium as they found it, meticulously picking up litter and stuffing it into blue plastic bags.

KEEN TUSSLE

Messi's Argentina begins title defence against Mahrez's Algeria



AFF Argentina starts its bid for back-to-back World Cups on Tuesday with a side full of familiar faces from Qatar 2022, facing Riyad Mahrez's Algerian team buoyed by warm-up wins. When the teams line up in Kansas City, all eyes will be on 38-year-old captain Lionel Messi, playing in a record sixth World Cup.

RARING TO GO

Odegaard says he is fit to play in Norway's opener against Iraq



GETTY IMAGES Norway captain Martin Odegaard says he has no concerns about fitness ahead of his side's opening World Cup Group I match in Foxborough, Massachusetts, on Tuesday. "I feel good. I don't know what you're so worried about — yes, I've had some trouble, as you know, but I feel good now," Odegaard said on Sunday.



REUTERS The hero: Vozinha kept Cape Verde in the game with a number of saves.

Gritty Cape Verde holds mighty Spain

The Africans do their nation proud on debut; the European champion fails to break the deadlock despite Yamal's entry late in the second half

FIFA WORLD CUP

Agence France-Presse ATLANTA

Spain's ghosts of recent World Cup horror shows reappeared in Atlanta as the European champion was held goalless by debutant Cape Verde in its opening game on Monday. Lamine Yamal was left on the bench as the Barcelona superstar gets back to top fitness after nearly two months out with a hamstring injury. Even his appearance as a second-half substitute failed to break down Cape Verde's dogged defence.

Since winning the World Cup for the first time in 2010, Spain has not won a knockout game. Ranked 67th in the world, Cape Verde was making its debut on the global stage and did a nation of just over 500,000 people proud. Atlanta's state-of-the-art air conditioned stadium meant there was no excuses for the slow tempo of Spain's build-up. It took until six minutes before half-time for Spain to seriously threaten. Marc Cucurella sent over a teasing cross that Ferran Torres tipped onto the crossbar and Cape Verde goalkeeper Vozinha got back on his feet to turn Mi-

kel Oyarzabal's looping header over the bar. Torres tested Vozinha again moments later before Aymeric Laporte's header from a corner was also clawed away by the Cape Verde No. 1 just before half-time. Yamal's appearance in the 71st minute instantly lifted the crowd and injected life into the pedestrian Spanish attack. His first involvement set up a decent opening for fellow substitute Mikel Merino which was too close to Vozinha. Yamal also began the move that saw Oyarzabal's effort deflected over in what was Spain's best chance of the second half.

Diallo's late strike wins it for Ivory Coast against Ecuador

Avon Sengupta PHILADELPHIA

World Cups have a habit of bringing together footballing worlds that rarely cross paths. In 33-degree heat, the rhythm of West Africa eventually overcame the resilience of the Andes as Ivory Coast beat Ecuador 1-0 here on Sunday to begin its 2026 World Cup campaign with a crucial victory. Neither side arrived in North America bearing the burden of expectation that follows the game's traditional powers, and it was Ivory Coast that left with momentum and belief on its side.

Ecuador almost made the perfect start. Veteran striker Enner Valencia should have given the South Americans the early lead after Emmanuel Agbadou slipped in the 10th minute while attempting to clear a hopeful ball into the box. The opportunity fell kindly for the skipper, but he dragged his effort just over the bar, much to the agony of the largely Ecuadorian crowd. Ivory Coast, returning to the World Cup after missing the last two editions, responded seven minutes later. Bazoumana Toure cut in from the left and unleashed a shot that passed the post by the length of a shoelace, the difference in millimetres between a roar and a groan. Agbadou's difficult opening spell almost proved costly again in the 23rd minute when another mistake allowed John Yeboah to unleash a shot that



AP Delight and despair: Sangare carries goal-scorer Diallo while an Ecuadorian player looks crestfallen.

left Yahia Fofana frozen in place. The goalkeeper watched in horror as the ball collided with the crossbar. Moments later, Alan Minda came even closer. Played through by Pedro Vite, he struck the woodwork once more as Ecuador, one of South America's most organised and dependable sides, began to find further cracks in the opposition defence. Ivory Coast, however, remained dangerous on the break. Alan Franco was forced into a last-ditch block to deny Nicolas Pepe after the former Arsenal winger had worked his way into a promising pocket of space, ensuring a breathless end to the opening half. After the restart, it was Ivory Coast's turn to rattle the crossbar as Elye Wahi burst clear of his marker. Yan Diomande then danced past a series of challenges inside the box, but the finish failed to match the choreography as

the ball sailed harmlessly high. Gonzalo Plata's powerful strike from distance forced Fofana into a rare moment of alarm. Fofana chose caution over confidence, parrying the ball back into play rather than holding on, but Ecuador was too slow to profit from the rebound. But after much of the evening was spent flirting with a breakthrough, it was Ivory Coast who found it in the dying embers of the match. Wilfried Singo threaded a pass to the edge of the box, and Amad Diallo supplied the composure that had been missing for much of the night, caressing his finish into the bottom-left corner to send his team into delirium. It was a cruel ending for Ecuador, which was left with nothing to show for its efforts. The victory kept Ivory Coast level on points with Germany, which had earlier started its Group E campaign with a 7-1 demolition of Curacao.



GETTY IMAGES Stellar show: Deepti recorded the best figures by an Indian in the tournament.

Deepti underlines her class on the big stage yet again

T20 WORLD CUP

P.K. Ajith Kumar BIRMINGHAM

When it comes to World Cups, Deepti Sharma would rather like to take five wickets. With the bat, she prefers to play innings that impact a game. Well, that may be a bit of an exaggeration, yes, but not totally untrue, if you consider her performance over the last few months. In the final of the 2025 ODI World Cup final at Navi Mumbai last November, she made a run-a-ball 58 that ensured India would put up a good enough total that would be beyond even the brilliant Laura Wolvaardt. And then she took five wickets, including that of the prolific, stylish South African captain.

Match-changing stand In her next World Cup match, albeit in a different format, she picked up five wickets again. That was after she was involved in a match-changing sixth-wicket partnership with Richa Ghosh in India's opening match at the T20 World Cup, against Pakistan at Edgbaston here on Sunday. So what is it with Deepti and World Cups? The 28-year-old answered that question at the press conference with her broadest smile.

Revel in pressure "I like the pressure (situations) and the ICC tournaments," she revealed. "I feel I have started (at this World Cup) from where I had finished. It feels good." Deepti has more than one reason to feel good now. With 166 wickets, she has once again become the leading bowler in Women's T20Is, overtaking Thai-

Vital part Her off-spin has become such a vital part in India's attack, regardless of conditions. And people have almost forgotten that she had once made 188 in an ODI. That was in 2017 against Ireland at Potchefstroom in South Africa. She had put on 320 for the opening wicket with Punam Raut. That remains the highest stand in women's ODIs. **Deepti underlines her class on the big stage yet again** **Deepti Sharma** would rather like to take five wickets. With the bat, she prefers to play innings that impact a game. Well, that may be a bit of an exaggeration, yes, but not totally untrue, if you consider her performance over the last few months. In the final of the 2025 ODI World Cup final at Navi Mumbai last November, she made a run-a-ball 58 that ensured India would put up a good enough total that would be beyond even the brilliant Laura Wolvaardt. And then she took five wickets, including that of the prolific, stylish South African captain.

Stat attack

1Curacao became the first team to concede seven or more goals on World Cup debut since 1954 (South Korea 0-9 vs. Hungary)

1For the first time, The Netherlands failed to win a World Cup game after taking the lead twice

1The Netherlands started a World Cup match without a player from the Eredivisie for the first time ever. Its opponent Japan fielded two players from the Dutch league (Watanabe and Ueda)

2Svanberg's goal 18 seconds after entering the field is the second fastest by a substitute in the World Cup since 1966, behind only Richard Morales (16 seconds, Uruguay vs. Senegal, 2002)

5Sweden's goals were its second highest after the eight it scored against Cuba in the 1938 quarterfinal

7Germany scored seven goals or more in a World Cup match for the third time

19Ecuador's unbeaten run in all competitions came to an end

20Neuer became the second goalkeeper (after Loris) to make 20 appearances in the football extravaganza

23y 338dDiallo is the youngest scorer for Ivory Coast in World Cup history

88Kamada's 88th-minute equaliser was the 'late'st goal in Japan's World Cup history

Compiled by Anirudh Velamuri

Shadows of Seoul 2002 resurface as France takes on Senegal

Avon Sengupta NEW JERSEY

Twenty-four years is a long time in football. Yet, when France and Senegal meet at the MetLife Stadium on Tuesday, the events of a June evening in Seoul will inevitably return to the conversation. The fixture carries echoes of one of the World Cup's most famous upsets, when Senegal, in 2002, marked its tournament debut by defeating defending champion France. Since then, the Frenchmen, under Didier Deschamps, have established themselves as one of international football's superpowers while Senegal has grown from an emerging force into one of Africa's most consistent sides. Deschamps' side has evolved from the pragmatism that delivered the 2018 triumph into a team equally comfortable controlling games through possession. The midfield, expected to revolve around Aurelien Tchouameni, will seek to



AFF Target men: Senegal's Mane and France's Mbappe will be tasked with scoring the goals.

give France's attackers the freedom to drift between the lines. The challenge against Senegal will be to move the ball quickly to stretch a compact defensive shape and create the one-versus-one situations in which its forwards usually thrive. At the heart of that threat will be Kylian Mbappe, operating from the left or drifting centrally to use his pace to create problems that few defenders can solve. But Senegal is unlikely to

spend the afternoon merely absorbing pressure. Its midfield is built around intensity, ball recoveries and vertical runs, while its attack thrives on directness rather than prolonged spells of possession. That approach could be especially effective against a French backbone that can be exposed when Theo Hernandez and Jules Kounde surge forward, leaving Nicolas Jackson with opportunities to exploit the space left behind. The shadows of 2002

THE RESULTS

Group E: Ivory Coast 1 (Diallo 90) bt Ecuador 0.
Group F: Netherlands 2 (Van Dijk 50, Summerville 64) drew with Japan 2 (Nakamura 57, Kamada 88); Sweden 5 (Ayari 7, 90+6, Isak 30, Gyokeres 59, Svanberg 84) bt Tunisia 1 (Rekkik 43).
Group H: Spain 0 drew with Cape Verde 0.
Wednesday's matches
GROUP I
France vs. Senegal, 00.30 a.m.
Iraq vs. Norway, 3.30 a.m.
GROUP J
Argentina vs. Algeria, 6.30 a.m.
Austria vs. Jordan, 9.30 a.m.
GROUP K
Portugal vs. DR Congo, 10.30 p.m.
The day and time(s) pertain to India

will inevitably follow this fixture. But France will insist that this is a different era and a different team. Senegal, meanwhile, will be keen to prove once again that reputation matters very little in football.

Today's matches

 Southampton , 7 p.m. IST HEAD-TO-HEAD Played: 17 New Zealand 14 Sri Lanka 2 NR 1	 Southampton , 11 p.m. IST HEAD-TO-HEAD Played: 4 England 3 Ireland 1
--	---

Sri Lanka-A fights back to pip India-A in Super Over thriller

It's the second successive loss for Tilak & Co.; Sooryavanshi gets involved in a heated exchange with Halambage and a few other players; Shedge and Vipraj score fifties to rescue the visiting side

TRI-SERIES

Shayan Acharya
DAMBULLA

Tensions simmered, tempers frayed and confusion reigned at the Rangiri International Stadium here on Monday as India-A suffered a seven-run defeat to Sri Lanka-A in a dramatic Super Over finish.

As the Indian players walked off, there was a sense of disbelief. A match that had seemed within their grasp had somehow slipped away. After recovering to make 265, thanks to maiden List A players from Suryansh Shedge and Vipraj Nigam, India-A found itself in winning po-



Frayed tempers: Sooryavanshi and a few Lankan players get into a heated argument at the end of the thrilling contest.

sitions before Sri Lanka-A fought back, led by a determined 93 from Sadeera Samarawickrama.

Making the most of a reprieve, Samarawickrama battled cramps through the closing stages and kept the host alive. When the scores were level at 265,

the match headed into a Super Over.

But not before controversy. India-A believed Chamika Gunasekara had not offered a shot during a crucial appeal late in the chase and argued its case passionately. The umpires disagreed. The fading light

soon became another talking point. Needing 17 runs from six balls, India-A's decision not to have Vaibhav Sooryavanshi face the first delivery raised eyebrows. With visibility far from ideal, India-A managed only nine runs.

Emotions spilled over at the end as Sooryavanshi was involved in a heated exchange with Vishen Halambage and a few Sri Lankan players, an ugly conclusion to an otherwise fiercely contested game.

The scores: India-A 265 in 49.2 overs (Ruturaj 37, Shedge 72, Vipraj 51, Shiraz 3/33, Vijaykanth 3/26) tied with Sri Lanka-A 265/9 in 50 overs (Dickwella 37, Samarawickrama 93).

Super Over: Sri Lanka-A 16/0 bt India-A 9/0; **Toss:** Sri Lanka; **PoM:** Samarawickrama.

Red-hot Hamilton turns doubt into destiny

FORMULA ONE

Anirudh Velamuri
HYDERABAD



Hamilton. AP

Two-and-a-half years ago, Ferrari and Lewis Hamilton shook Formula 1 to its core.

They sent shockwaves through the paddock which eventually reshaped the grid. Drivers scrambled for seats, veterans found themselves discarded, and rookies were thrust into the spotlight.

The euphoria surrounding Hamilton's switch slow-

ly gave way to frustration as it became painfully clear that the Prancing Horse did not possess a car capable of carrying him to an unprecedented eighth World title.

Suddenly, what was supposed to be the final glorious chapter of a legendary career began to look like a gamble gone wrong.

Then came the ultimate twist of the knife. Mercedes – the team Hamilton had left behind – returned this season with the benchmark car, sweeping every race heading into the Spanish GP.

Sport, however, has always reserved its greatest stories for those willing to keep believing. For Hamilton, that unfolded at the Circuit de Barcelona-Catalunya.

The precision in qualifying was vintage Hamilton. Even Ferrari's often-maligned strategy delivered when it mattered most. For one glorious afternoon, driver, car and team moved as one.

Spain was simply the moment the world could no longer ignore them. And when the chequered flag finally fell, Hamilton's voice crackled over the radio. "Thank you so much! You've helped me achieve this dream."

Only, this is no longer a dream. It is reality. A scarlet reality.

SNAPSHOTS

Rithvik triumphs
CHENNAI: India's Rithvik Sanjeevi defeated Croatia's Aria Dinata 17-21, 23-21, 21-16 in the final of Valence Alpes International Badminton Challenge at the Palais des Sports Pierre Mendes-France on Sunday.



Rithvik.

Indian squash team for Asian Games
The Squash Rackets Federation of India has provisionally selected the Indian men's and women's teams for the Asian Games to be held in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan, after the four-day trials that concluded at the ISTA on Monday.

The teams: Men: Abhay Singh, Veer Chotrani, Velavan Senthilkumar, Suraj Chand. **Women:** Anahat Singh, Tanvi Khanna, Joshna Chinappa, Shameena Riaz.

Online tickets for India-Afghanistan third ODI go on sale
Phase two of the online ticket sales for the third ODI between India and Afghanistan in Chennai has commenced. Fans can purchase tickets through the District website (www.district.in) and app.

Ticket prices: F and H Upper: ₹1,500; **F Lower:** ₹2,000; **I, J and K Upper:** ₹2,500; **I, J and K Lower:** ₹3,000; **KMK Terrace:** ₹5,000. *Gates will open at 11 a.m. on match day.*

Nagal, Sahaja to lead tennis teams at Asiad
NEW DELHI: Sumit Nagal and Sahaja Yamalapalli will spearhead the country's tennis campaign at the 20th Asian Games in Japan as the AITA on Monday picked a six-member men's and women's squad.

The teams: Men: Sumit Nagal, Manas Dhamne, Dhakshinewar Suresh, Yuki Bhambri, N. Sriram



CRICKET ROUND-UP

Thejaswini shines in Chengalpattu's victory
CHENGALPATTU: D. Thejaswini produced an all-round effort (102 n.o. and 3/17) as Chengalpattu thrashed Mayiladuthurai by 140 runs under the VJD method in the first round of the TNCA inter-district women's tournament on Monday.

The scores (first round): Zone-D (Salem): Tiruvallur 96 in 41.4 overs (P. Sonika 3/31) lost to Salem 100/5 in 30.5 overs (S. Vaishnavi 53, D. Swagata 3/21).

Zone-E (Chengalpattu): Chengalpattu 287/6 in 50 overs (S. Lithisha 67 n.o., D. Thejaswini 102 n.o., S. Dekshanaa 3/40) bt Mayiladuthurai 58/7 in 22.2 overs (D. Thejaswini 3/17). *Note:* Chengalpattu won by 140 runs by VJD Method. (Par score 198 in 22.2 overs).

Zone-H (Tirunelveli): Kancheepuram 136 in 33.5 overs (Mridula Sriram 37, M.V. Vishnu Priyaa 33, S. Pooja 4/24) lost to Tenkasi 137/0 in 21.4 overs (B. Kaviya Muthulakshmi 72 n.o., M. Anusuya 37 n.o.).

Sharwin scalps five
CHENGALPATTU: S.K. Sharwin's five for 46 helped Dindigul bowl out host Chengalpattu for 173 on the opening day of the two-day TNCA inter-district under-19 quarterfinal on Monday. At Tiruvallur, skipper U. Jakvis Yosaph's unbeaten 110 was the lone bright spot for Kanyakumari, which was bowled out for 188 against the home team.

The scores: Quarterfinals: At Chengalpattu: Chengalpattu 173 in 55 overs (Thejeshwar Ganesh 48, B. Akshadh Rao 53, N. Rakshan 37, S.K. Sharwin 5/46) vs. Dindigul 54/3 in 18.1 overs.

At Tiruvallur: Kanyakumari 188 in 75.5 overs (U. Jakvis Yosaph 110 n.o., K. Karmegam 4/63) vs. Tiruvallur 22/0 in five overs.

At Coimbatore: Coimbatore 207 in 66.2 overs (K. Rahul 59, P.D. Tirukarthikeyan 44, R. Rakesh 6/81) vs. Ranipet 36/2 in 15 overs.

At Namakkal: Salem 222 in 64.4 overs (S. Pugal 59, V.G. Pugal Vishnu 48, M.G. Nithilan 5/36, A.S. Aswin Adhav 3/63) vs. Namakkal 48/4 in 25 overs (V. Dhekkshith 3/18).

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Golf in India needs more infrastructure and promotion

As president of the PGTI, the Indian cricket legend is determined to take the sport to different parts of the country, broaden its reach and generate greater interest; laments the lack of courses in smaller cities

INTERVIEW

Kapil Dev

Anirudh Velamuri

Some victories fade with time. Others grow larger than the moment itself. More than four decades on, India's triumph at the 1983 World Cup belongs firmly in the latter category.

For an entire generation, it was the day Indian cricket discovered what was possible. For those that followed, it became the moment that changed everything. At the centre of that transformation stood Kapil Dev, the man who altered the trajectory of Indian cricket forever.

That version of him has become part of India's sporting consciousness, preserved in memory and immortalised in countless highlight reels. The man, however, has long since moved on.

Retirement opened the door to a different passion. Golf, a sport he discovered after cricket, gradually became a defining part of his life. What began as a post-retirement curiosity evolved into a passion, and eventually a mission. Today, as president of the DP World Professional Golf Tour of India, Kapil finds himself championing a sport he only discovered after hanging up his cricket boots, investing in its future with the same enthusiasm that once powered India's charge on cricket fields around the world.

The setting for this conversation could scarcely be further removed from the frenzy that once surrounded him. Tucked away well outside the hustle and bustle of New Delhi city is Kapil's farmhouse, where there are barely any indications that it's the residence of one of India's most celebrated athletes. There are no ostentatious reminders of sporting greatness, no shrine to a glittering career. Instead, the property breathes a different kind of richness.

Vegetable patches stretch across the grounds. Open spaces invite silence rather than spectacle. More than 40 rescue dogs, cared for by his wife Romi, roam the expansive compound. It is here, amid the stillness, that *The Hindu* sat down with the 67-year-old to discuss what he calls, somewhat surprisingly, the finest phase of his life. Excerpts:

Talk to us about your interest in golf. How did that happen?

This has been a beautiful journey. Basically, when I stopped playing cricket, I wondered what to do next. Either you go to television and start talking about cricket or do coaching, most probably. But I wanted to stay away from people,

because you're with them for almost 15-20 years. You now want to just chill and relax.

A friend of mine introduced me to golf and I loved it. Why? Only one reason. I'm not depending on somebody. I played sports where I depended on others (before) but this gave me a thrill.

I'm not saying cricket didn't give me that, it gave me more than anything I could ever imagine in several lives. But this gave me a special kick.

How did it go from a hobby to serving as the president of PGTI today?

When you meet golfers here, you come to know how much hard work they put in and the reward they get is not up to that standard, even though they work even harder than cricketers. I felt that we can help them have a better life with the sport

Why should they not get a chance to become better athletes and also earn a livelihood? That's what changed my thought process and I told myself that I should do something for golf.

Had I not (started) played the game, I wouldn't have done anything, to be honest.

And any sport in India, not just golf, the moment people start following it, their bar for it is cricket, where India is a dominant force. So when somebody like Aditi Ashok plays in the Olympics, or Jeev Milkha Singh and Shubhankar Sharma take part in other international events, the expectations inherently comes with an unfair expectation of medals and titles...

It's not right to compare. Cricket has its own place, as does golf and football and every other sport. Yes everybody talks about cricket in India and that's because the administration has done well to take it up to that level. At this stage, golf in India needs infrastructure, the most important thing for any sport.

Look at cricket today, we're talking about being the best in the world because our infrastructure is better than any other country's. Hats off to the cricket board, they're giving young players all the facilities they require.

Take any sport, or even beyond. Our country has produced so many software engineers because we've given them the right platform. That's why today we're talking about Indians being some of the best in that field.

And how is PGTI working on extending those opportunities beyond your big cities?

We don't have many golf courses in smaller cities. They're coming up only now. In the last 10 years, we have organised tournaments in various 'smaller' cities, like the one in Raipur.

If you give people a chance, maybe golf will also have someone like (MS)



I admire Tiger Woods, without a doubt. I would say he has done more for golf than anyone else. I'm not taking the credit away from others but I think he was one person who had the biggest impact

Dhoni come from Jharkhand or elsewhere. We need to give those opportunities, for which we require a lot more golf courses. If we have that, we will produce a world champion. As administrators, it is our job to give those opportunities, not only boys but girls also. Take Aditi, she has done impressively globally and now people understand that Indians are very close to winning the medals that nobody thought we could.

Is there a push from PGTI to ensure that this kind of interest is taken up at the school level?

That's very tough. Yes, it will be nice, but every school can't have a driving range, even the bare minimum required for kids to start hitting the ball. Schools in smaller cities can do it a lot more easily than those in big cities like Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Bengaluru and Chennai, because the land is not so freely accessible. But we want to walk, slowly, before we run. We want to make sure every year we take the sport to different parts of the country to not only expand its footprint but also increase the interest.

Is live telecast, on TV or online, something you are focusing on?

We cannot compare any sport with cricket, they're doing it for the last 50 years. Besides cricket, no game is really televised that much in India. Yes, we're working very hard with our commentators to help people look at golf as the beautiful game that it is.

When a big event, like the Olympics, comes around, fans are focused on the sports where they think a medal is a possibility. This makes golf an afterthought. How do you, who has been one of the greatest athletes the country has produced, think we can get over this mindset?

Yes, you would like to see your country win medals but people should go and admire the sport for what they are. We should admire and support our own people.

In our country, people are still not eagerly making a profession out of sports. They're not making a life out of that. In cricket, they are. Today people come to me and say that they want to play in the IPL. I feel very sorry. I want them to say that they want to play for India. But I can understand as they see how they're going to make their life through the IPL. But my aim is always higher. You should look to make a name for your country.

On that note, PGTI has done well to increase the prize money pool every year. How easy or difficult has that been? And what is your aim going forward?

It was not hard. I just talked to my friends and tried to convince them. Lots and lots of friends of mine have come forward to try and promote the game. I can only say we shouldn't expect the government to solely do everything for us, for any sport.

We can take help from the corporate world, they have the money to put in sports. Not only golf but anything. It's our responsibility to tap that avenue and make the game bigger. We're ready to take CSR (Corporate Social Responsibility) money also.

If there is no money, people will let it go. The young kids will have a passion up to one level. When we start making life through sports the game will change in our country, the way cricket has.

The league system is one obvious way to take a sport forward in India and golf has two of them. Despite being rivals, you welcomed it wholeheartedly.

IPL has given a lot of sports thought process. We should have a league where we can make a life for the players. And, 72 The League is a way for us to look after our people. You can't look after all the 400-500 people but if you look after the top 50-100 people, it will trickle down. This league gives opportunities for players to show their talent and play like a team. Golf is very individualistic but we wanted to give them the taste of teamwork also.

We want to have four or five leagues, as long as every league has its own agenda. We are very happy as long as they look after the players. I would welcome anybody to put money into golf.

According to you, what has been the biggest change you have seen in golf in your time with PGTI?

I think the self-belief in youngsters has increased. Not in golf, but in all sports. In our time, cricketers were slightly subdued. Today, you see the younger

kids come out and speak their mind. We never used to do that. That's a good thing, but they also have to know where to draw a line on what they say. We have to learn how to balance.

Do you think your stature in the country has helped golf in a way?

I can't say that about myself. I do have a passion for golf. And if people pick up because of that, I will feel very happy. But it's not for me to say how much my stature has helped golf.

You recently met the Lieutenant Governor of Delhi to make it the golf capital of the country. Can you shed some light on that?

We have around 14-15 golf courses here. I don't know any other city that has more.

In winter, if you want to play golf, you will not get a chance at all of them in Delhi, as the game is growing. But we have to make it more professional. At the moment, people want to play for fun. But when a top player comes out from this game, it will be different. That is what we spoke about. We want to promote the game.

And do you have a favourite golf course, either in the country or abroad?

More than the location, I think it's the company that's very important. I mean, if you're playing cricket and get a chance to play with Virat Kohli, Sachin Tendulkar, Jasprit Bumrah or Sunil Gavaskar, that is enjoyable and memorable.

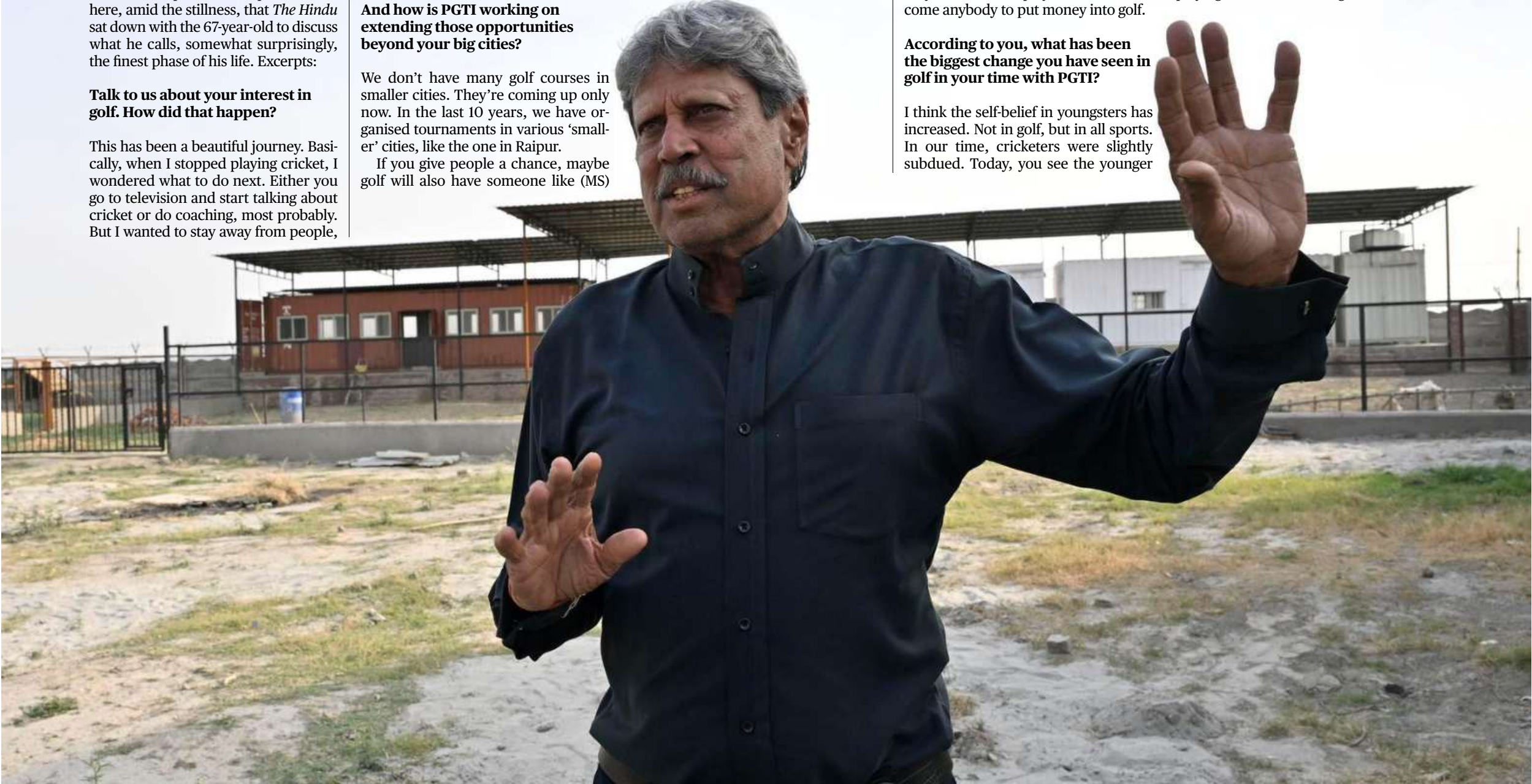
It is the same for me too, it's not the golf courses but the people whom you play with that is very, very important. Because I'm not a professional, I like to go and meet successful people, understand them and enjoy the experience. I remember once I went to Australia for some company I was working with. The chairman of that company played golf on a Sunday with me. On Monday, I had a meeting with him for something. I went to his office for a 10 o'clock meeting but he was busy with other things. He just signed my papers, saying that he can judge someone by playing with them on the golf course.



I don't see anything as a challenge. I enjoy my work. But when you walk out or go to office, only one thought persists: Can I do something more for the community?



SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR



Traditional models, based on physics, don't avoid anticipating unusually extreme events. WINDY.COM

AI falls short on extreme weather forecasting

Vasudevan Mukunth

In the last two years, artificial intelligence (AI) has moved from science fiction to the frontlines of computer science, mathematics, and engineering, among others. Its consequences have been particularly pronounced in the domain of weather forecasting, where models from companies like Google and Huawei have proved faster and often more accurate than the large supercomputers we have relied on for decades.

However, a new study published in *Science Advances* suggests that when it comes to the most dangerous weather events, AI still has a lot to learn.

In the study, researchers from Germany and Switzerland compared several leading AI weather models, including GraphCast, Pangu-Weather, and Fuxi, against the world's gold standard for traditional forecasting: the high-resolution (HRES) model of the European Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasts.

AI models are trained to look for patterns based on historical weather data so when weather does something completely unprecedented AI models have no basis to anticipate it

They found that while the AI models excelled at predicting 'normal' weather and even moderate extremes, they consistently failed to accurately predict events that would shatter records.

Traditional models are based on physics, and use complex mathematical equations to describe how air and heat move, how moisture turns into rain, and so on. Because they rely literally on the laws of nature, they can anticipate a scenario even if it has never happened before. However, AI models are data-driven. They are trained to look for patterns based on 40 years of historical weather data (1979-2017), so when the weather does something completely unprecedented – like a record-setting heatwave – the AI models have no basis to anticipate it.

This is called an extrapolation problem: that is, AI is great at interpolating, or predicting things within the range of what it has seen, but it struggles to predict things far outside of its training data.

The researchers also tested the models on record-breaking heat, cold, and wind events from 2018 and 2020 and found that the AI models systematically underestimated both the frequency and the intensity of these events.

For example, during an extreme heatwave, the AI models tended to predict temperatures that were significantly lower than what actually occurred. Specifically, they responded as if there was an invisible ‘cap’ on how high the temperature could go. And the more a record was broken by, the larger the AI models’ error became.

If a study or a policy is based on AI models that predict a severe heatwave but the actual temperature is even higher, the disaster response could be inadequate. Early warning systems for heatwaves, floods, and storms still require the highest possible accuracy during extreme weather to save lives.

“Given the remarkably fast evolution of AI models in recent years, there are promising ways to further improve these models even for forecasting record-breaking extremes,” the authors wrote. “Nevertheless, the current generation still underperforms HRES exactly during the potentially most impactful weather events, including record-breaking heat and cold events.”.

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THE SCIENCE QUIZ

Of things that are, or ought to be, black

Vasudevan Mukunth

QUESTION 1

If you are in a room with no light, you can still only see a dark grey colour called _____, Germany for "intrinsic grey". This happens due to the random electrical signals from your optic nerves that your brain interprets as faint light. Fill in the blank.

QUESTION 2

Biologists have discovered species of deep-sea fish, like the Pacific blackdragon, with ultra-black skin that absorbs 99.5% of all light that hits it. These fish have a structural layer of X, the organelles that synthesise melanin, that trap light in a maze-like structure. Name X.

QUESTION 3

The material Vantablack is so dark because it is a forest of vertical Y. When light enters the material, it gets trapped between the structures of the Y and bounces around until it is converted into heat. Thus Vantablack absorbs 99.965% of radiation. Name Y.

QUESTION 4

A black hole isn't actually black or a hole. It is a region of space where gravity is so strong that the escape velocity exceeds that of light. In fact, black holes may emit faint amounts of energy called _____. If a black hole were small enough, it would actually be white-hot. Fill in the blanks.

A woman wearing a pink long-sleeved shirt is holding a red awareness ribbon in her right hand. The ribbon is tied in a loop, and she is holding it by the ends. The background is a plain, light blue wall.

The democratisation of cancer knowledge is important, especially in India, where accessing oncologists is itself challenging for many. ANGIOLA HARRY/UNSPLASH

According to one JAMA study on diagnostic accuracy, when LLMs encounter complex cases requiring contextual reasoning, their accuracy drops significantly, well below the level of an experienced physician

because the LLM made them feel understood. In oncology, delay is often catastrophic. I have seen patients postpone cancer evaluation because they felt the LLM had validated their “wait and see” approach.

Judging what is right

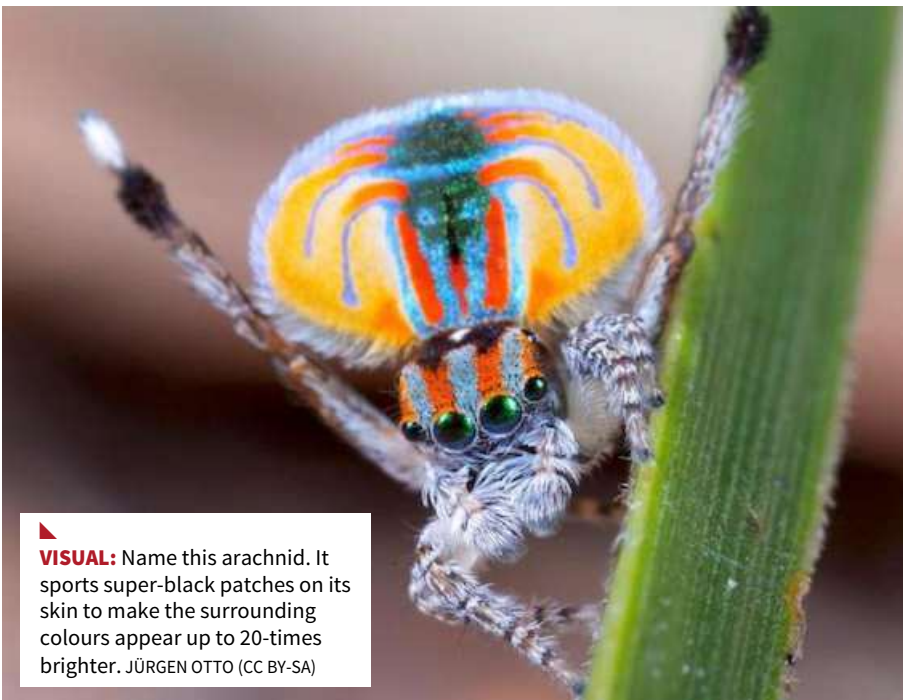
A 52-year-old asked ChatGPT about a lung nodule found incidentally on a CT scan. The LLM explained that most lung nodules are benign. The patient was reassured and did not follow up. Eighteen months later, he has stage III lung cancer that was likely stage I when he first noticed it. The LLM provided accurate population-level statistics without context about what his nodule required.

Another patient with breast cancer asked an LLM about stopping hormone therapy after three years. The algorithm discussed “natural approaches” and how some women manage without medication. She stopped and soon relapsed. When asked why she stopped, she said the LLM made it sound optional. But it was not optional for her.

These are stories of real patients harmed by a tool we have unleashed without fully understanding how to control it.

Further, I am not convinced these tools will ever be able to do what actually matters in medicine: judging what is right for the individual sitting in front of us, not what is statistically true for most populations.

I am not worried that LLMs will replace



Answers to June 4 quiz:

1. The phenomenon where light is magnified by gravity – **Ans: Gravitational lensing**
2. Spacecraft designed to be pushed forward by light – **Ans: Light-sail**
3. Light that appears nears surfaces, fades rapidly away from it – **Ans: Evanescent waves**
4. How light's electric field moves when it's circularly polarised – **Ans: Rotates**
5. Space acquired this property due to ultra-strong magnetic fields – **Ans: Birefringent**

Visual: **Rayleigh scattering**
First contact: Utsav Kaushal
Ranjan | Tamal Biswas | K.N.
Viswanathan | Shreya Kapoor |
Anmol Agrawal

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Number of protesters executed in Iran in 2026

18 Iran has executed at least 40 people, including 18 protesters, on “national security grounds” since the start of 2026, the United Nations said on Monday. UN rights chief Volker Turk said he felt “deeply for the people in Iran, caught between war and cruel repression”. Iran executes more people annually than any other nation besides China, according to rights groups. AFP

Percentage rise in India’s exports in May 2026

18 in per cent. The country’s merchandise exports rose 18% to \$45.2 billion, according to the commerce ministry data. Imports, too, grew 20.62% to \$73.41 billion in May, leaving a trade deficit of \$28.21 billion. India’s merchandise exports rose to \$88.91 billion during April-May 2026-27, marking a 16.09% growth over the corresponding period last year. PTI

Drone-strike deaths in Sudan in first five months of 2026

1,000 The UN rights chief on Monday condemned a “sharp increase” in the use of drone warfare in conflict-torn Sudan, where more than 1,000 civilians were killed in such strikes in the first five months of this year. Drone warfare has become an increasingly prominent feature of Sudan’s conflict since it erupted in April 2023. AFP

Number of persons killed in Haiti gang violence this year

2,300 Gang violence has killed at least 2,300 people in Haiti this year, while nearly 100 have been kidnapped, the United Nations said on Monday. UN human rights chief Volker Turk called on the authorities to tackle the rampant impunity in the crisis-ravaged Caribbean nation of 12 million people. AFP

Amount allocated for Bengal under VB-G RAM G scheme

8,508 in ₹ crore. West Bengal has been allocated ₹8,508 crore under the scheme for the 2026-27 financial year, according to figures released by the Union government. Under the Gram Sadak Yojana, allocations worth ₹2,400 crore have been approved and ₹1,000 crore released by the Centre. PTI

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Drone revolution and modern warfare

The wars in Ukraine, Lebanon and West Asia have shown how drones have become central to modern warfare; as cheap, mass-produced unmanned systems proliferate, military power is increasingly shaped by industrial scale, technological adaptation and the ability to build, deploy and counter drones

EXPLAINER

Rahul Bedi

For decades, military power has been defined by the scale and sophistication of conventional arsenals – combat aircraft, tanks, artillery, warships, air-defence systems, precision-guided missiles, and other high-end assets.

End of superiority

In this environment, battlefield superiority belonged to armies with technologically advanced platforms and equipment, sophisticated intelligence networks, and large budgets. Smaller militaries and non-state actors, by contrast, were largely confined to asymmetric tactics that relied on guerrilla warfare, ambushes, and other unconventional methods to offset their opponents’ superior firepower and operational dominance.

But the ongoing wars in Ukraine and Lebanon, together with the wider U.S.-Israel-Iran theatre of conflict, have irrevocably shattered this paradigm, demonstrating that commercially derived drones – mass-produced at scale, rapidly reconfigured for multiple operational roles, and widely deployed – have become a defining feature of contemporary warfare. Performing functions ranging from intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance (ISR) and target acquisition to precision strikes, artillery spotting, electronic warfare, and logistics support, they have evolved from auxiliary assets into central instruments of military operations.

In doing so, they have transformed the 21st-century battlespace into an environment of persistent visibility and rapid engagement, where front lines remain continuously exposed, and rear areas can no longer be assumed secure, as multiple types of Unmanned Aerial Systems (UAS) can locate, track, and strike targets with unprecedented speed and precision.

Across these concurrent theatres of conflict, the widespread – and in some cases decisive – employment of drones has challenged established assumptions about how military power is generated and applied, reshaping doctrine, force structures, and future warfighting concepts. The consequence has been the emergence of a continuous and interconnected battlespace in which no position is truly beyond reach, and no movement can safely assume it will remain concealed for long, as detection is increasingly followed by rapid engagement and destruction.

Ukraine drone war

Nowhere has this transformation been more visible than in Ukraine, where Russia’s ‘Special Military Operation’ launched in February 2022, as a conventional war involving combat aircraft, tanks and artillery, evolved within two years into the world’s first industrial-scale, drone-intensive conflict.

From the earliest stages of the Russian invasion, Ukraine rapidly adapted commercially available drones – originally designed for civilian purposes such as aerial photography, mapping, and basic surveillance – alongside a limited number of pre-existing military Unmanned Aerial Vehicle (UAV) assets into improvised reconnaissance and strike systems.

What had initially functioned as a support tool for intelligence gathering and



From the earliest stages of Russian invasion, Ukraine adapted commercially available drones. FILE PHOTO

guiding artillery fire quickly evolved into a decisive combat capability, as small quadcopters and First-Person View (FPV) drones were progressively weaponised and deployed as low-cost, precision-guided munitions. This shift marked a fundamental transformation in how unmanned systems were used on the battlefield: from passive information-gathering platforms to active instruments of destruction. By around 2024, drones had become fully integrated into almost every layer of Ukrainian combat, ranging from tactical battlefield surveillance to frontline targeting and deep-strike missions against logistics hubs, supply routes, and rear-area infrastructure.

The operational template that emerged from this experience in Ukraine was subsequently replicated, albeit to varying degrees and in different forms, across the continuing West Asian conflicts, underscoring the growing centrality of drones to contemporary warfare.

FPV revolution

At the heart of Ukraine’s drone revolution is the FPV system – an inexpensive, commercially available platform originally designed for recreational racing and aerial photography. Controlled through a live video feed transmitted from an onboard camera to virtual-reality-style goggles worn by their operators, FPV systems offer exceptional precision, manoeuvrability, and responsiveness.

These were then rapidly transformed into a broad spectrum of combat systems, including FPV strike drones, bombers, interceptors, and long-range attack variants. Among the most prominent are heavy-lift hexacopter Vampire drones – nicknamed “Baba Yaga” by Russian forces after the fearsome figure from Slavic folklore – alongside a vast number of improvised modular platforms, assembled in multiple workshops across Ukraine.

The most common are FPV kamikaze or strike drones, inexpensive quadcopters carrying explosive payloads such as modified rocket-propelled grenade warheads or purpose-built munitions, flown directly into targets as disposable precision-guided missiles. Their extremely low cost has radically reshaped battlefield economics which enable systems worth only a few hundred dollars to destroy armoured vehicles and equipment valued in the millions.

These systems operate within a broader Ukrainian deep-strike drone architecture that includes loitering munitions such as RAM II and UJ-31 Zozulya. The latter functions as an aerially deployed “parasite drone,” carried by the Ukrainian-designed multi-purpose UJ-22 Airborne long-range UAV’s, enabling penetration of contested airspace under intensive electronic warfare conditions and extending operational reach. RAM II, by contrast, is a short-range precision loitering munition employed in coordination with reconnaissance drones like the locally developed Shark and PD-2, with improved variants offering greater range and endurance to expand their engagement envelope against air defence systems and rear-area targets.

Also included within Ukraine’s expanding drone inventory are bomber drones – largely adapted from commercial DJI Mavic 3 and DJI Matrice 300 RTK quadcopter platforms originally designed for aerial photography, surveying and industrial applications – which carry and release grenades, anti-tank mines and improvised munitions. Unlike kamikaze systems, they survive missions and can conduct multiple sorties, making them particularly effective against trenches, bunkers and other static positions.

Alongside these, Ukraine fields FPV-based strike systems like Pegasus and long-range, one-way attack drones designed to strike deep inside Russian territory against logistics hubs, airbases and critical infrastructure, far beyond the frontline. In practice, however, the distinction between FPV strike drones and loitering munitions has become increasingly blurred, with many FPV-based thermal and night-vision-equipped variants for round-the-clock operations.

But, Ukraine’s most significant innovation has been the emergence of fibre-optic FPV drones, an electronic warfare (EW)-resistant class of systems. Unlike conventional drones, which rely on radio-frequency links vulnerable to jamming, these platforms transmit commands and video through ultra-thin fibre-optic cables that spool out during flight, rendering electronic interference largely ineffective. In heavily contested electromagnetic environments, this capability restores a significant operational advantage to drone operators by enabling missions to be conducted

largely free from electronic disruption.

Regional drone networks

Meanwhile, unlike Ukraine, Hezbollah’s offensive UAS capability is primarily built around Iranian-supplied platforms with limited local modification, relying heavily on systems like Ababil, Mohajer, and Shahed series. These platforms provide a layered operational architecture spanning ISR and strike functions. Within this framework, the Mohajer-4 and Shahed-129 provide tiered-ISR coverage across medium- to long-ranges, while the Shahed-136 loitering munition fulfils a ‘dedicated’ one-way strike role across a wider regional theatre.

More recently, Hezbollah has also adopted jamming-resistant fibre-optic FPV drones, enabling operations in heavily contested electromagnetic environments and enhancing close-range reconnaissance and precision strike effectiveness despite extensive Israeli EW measures.

In response, the Israel Defence Forces (IDF) in Lebanon have developed a layered counter-drone architecture, integrating EW systems, specialised radar arrays, and experimental platforms like the AI-enabled Iron Drone Raider, designed to neutralise low-altitude UAVs through kinetic, non-explosive interception methods such as net capture – by which a physical net is deployed to entangle and disable an incoming drone mid-air – or direct collision, rather than costly missile engagements. Alongside this, the IDF operates a multi-tiered UAV force structure combining long-endurance Heron systems for persistent ISR with armed drones and loitering munitions integrated into reconnaissance-strike complexes for rapid engagement.

Iran, for its part, constitutes a third and structurally distinct model of drone warfare.

Rather than employing drones solely as tactical assets, the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) integrates them into a broader strategy of deterrence, coercion, and power projection against the U.S.-Israel combine and their regional partners across West Asia.

Through indigenous systems such as Shahed drone variants, alongside platforms supplied to proxy forces across Iraq, Syria, Lebanon, and Yemen, the IRGC has demonstrated an ability to threaten military bases, critical infrastructure, and naval assets across West Asia at relatively low cost.

Economy shift

Thus, across ongoing wars and conflicts, the drone revolution is defined as much by economics as technology. Cheap, mass-produced unmanned systems are swiftly and irreversibly replacing reliance on expensive platforms, complex logistics, and specialised military structures, shifting the advantage toward the scale, speed, and production capacity of UAS ecosystems.

Warfare, therefore, is increasingly becoming a test of industrial endurance and relentless technological adaptation, where success depends on the ability to build, deploy, and counter fast-evolving, continuously reconfigured drone systems. And, in this rapidly evolving battlespace, drones are no longer just weapons, but the very infrastructure of modern-day war – shaping how conflicts are surveilled, fought, sustained, and ultimately decided.

(Rahul Bedi is a journalist based in New Delhi and Chandigarh specialising in military, defence and security matters)

THE GIST

Ukraine has pioneered industrial-scale drone warfare, integrating FPV drones, loitering munitions, bomber drones and fibre-optic systems across reconnaissance, targeting and deep-strike missions.

Low-cost FPV strike drones have transformed battlefield economics, enabling systems worth a few hundred dollars to destroy armoured vehicles and equipment valued in the millions.

The widespread adoption of drones has challenged traditional assumptions about military power, creating a continuous battlespace where detection is increasingly followed by rapid engagement and destruction.

Mitchell Valdes-Sosa



CM
YK